MODERN ALGEBRA: INTRODUCTION TO REPRESENTATION THEORY (2026 FALL @ NTU)

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1. Lecture 1: Representation of a group

The reference for the first part of this course (representation theory of finite groups) is [Ser77].

1.1. **What is a representation of a group?** Needless to say, the notion of a *group* is one of the most fundamental and important concepts in mathematics. Therefore, it is a basic motivation to "understand" a given group (say, G) in some sense. However, when can we really say "OK, now we have understood this group G"?

Because this is not a rigorous (mathematically formulated) problem, there is also no rigorous answer; rather, there should be a lot of answers.

For example, one can claim that it is enough to describe the multiplication table for all elements of a given group G. The multiplication law of a group G is nothing but the whole group structure of G, so it indeed characterize the group G. In this sense, it should be a complete answer to the above problem. However, as you can imagine easily, describing the multiplication table is not always so practical to express the nature of the given group G.

Example 1.1. Let G be the group whose elements consist of a, b, c, d satisfying the following multiplication table:

$\cdot$	a	b	c	d
a	a	b	c	d
b	b	c	d	a
c	c	d	a	b
d	d	a	b	c

In fact, this group is just $\mathbb{Z}/4\mathbb{Z}$, where $0, 1, 2, 3 \in \mathbb{Z}/4\mathbb{Z}$ are denoted by a, b, c, d, respectively. It is obvious that this way of expressing $\mathbb{Z}/4\mathbb{Z}$ is just making the situation complicated!

Another possible answer should be to describe a set of generators and relations of a given group G. Indeed, this can be a complete "answer", in the sense that a set of generators and relations completely characterize the group G. However, for any given group G, a set of generators and relations may not be unique; sometimes, a bad choice of generators and relations does not make the structure of the given group G transparent. To see this, let us look at the following bad example:

Example 1.2. Let $G := \mathbb{Z}/4\mathbb{Z}$. This group can be written as

$$\langle x, y \mid x^2 = y,\ y^2 = 1,\ xy = yx \rangle.$$

Of course, the relation $x^2 = y$ reduces this to

$$\langle x \mid x^4 = 1 \rangle,$$

which should be the most standard presentation of $\mathbb{Z}/4\mathbb{Z}$.

These observations suggest that there can be many different ways to formulate what it means to "understand a group". *Representation theory*, which we will study in this course, is one way to formulate the meaning of "understand a group".

Here, we caution that although we understand everything about representations of a given group G, it does not mean that we understand everything about G. For example, knowing all about representation theory of G does not necessarily enable us to describe the multiplication table of nor a set of generators and relations of G. What is important is that the notion of representation appears in various area of mathematics (or, even mathematical physics). Of course, representations of groups are interesting objects of study in their own right, but much of their value also comes from their usefulness and applications in many different areas of mathematics.

Now let us define the notion of a representation.

Definition 1.3. Let G be a group. A *representation* of G is a pair (π, V) of a $\mathbb{C}$-vector space V and an action of G on V, i.e., a map

$$G \times V \to V \colon (g, v) \mapsto g \cdot v$$

such that the induced map

$$\pi \colon G \to \mathrm{Aut}_{\mathbb{C}}(V) \colon g \mapsto [\pi(g) \colon v \mapsto g \cdot v]$$

is a group homomorphism.

It is often said that "a group is a set of symmetries". If we follow this slogan, we can say that "a representation of a group G is a realization of the symmetries contained in G on a vector space". To put it somewhat poetically, a representation of a group is a "shadow" it casts on a vector space.

Remark 1.4.
(1) By convention (which is normal in representation theory), we sometimes write only one of π and V to mean a representation (π, V) of a group G. For example, we often say "let π be a representaion of G" or "let V be a representation of G".
(2) Somewhat confusingly, we may also use π to refer to both the action and the underlying vector space. For example, we often say "let π be a representation of G and we take an element $v \in \pi$".
(3) When we only write V for a representation of G, we often use the symbol "$\cdot$" for denoting the action of G on V. For example, we write "let $g \in G$, $v \in V$ and we consider $g \cdot v$".

For a given group G, there are various possible representations of G. For example, we always have the *trivial representation*, which can be considered for any group G:

Example 1.5. Let $V := \mathbb{C}$ and π be the trivial action of G on $V = \mathbb{C}$. We call (V, π) the *trivial representation* of G.

The trivial representation is actually very important; but, of course, we cannot know anything about G only by looking at its trivial representation. The important idea of representation theory is to understand the give group G through its various representations ("what kinds of shadows G can cast on vector spaces"). Accordingly, the most important problem in representation theory is:

classifying all representations of G.

Example 1.6. Let G be a group and (π, V) be a 1-dimensional representation of G. Then π is identified with a homomorphism $\pi\colon G \to \mathbb{C}^\times$ (since $\mathrm{Aut}_{\mathbb{C}}(V) = \mathbb{C}^\times$). A homomorphism $G \to \mathbb{C}^\times$ is often referred to as a *character* (or 1-*dimensional character*) of G.

Remark 1.7.

(1) In this course, we only consider representations of a group realized on $\mathbb{C}$-vector spaces. However, in general, representation theory heavily depends on the coefficient field of vector spaces. Especially, the whole theory drastically changes when we replace $\mathbb{C}$ with a non-algebraically-closed field or a field of positive characteristic (basically, theory becomes much more difficult).

(2) It is often the case that the group G of our interest is a topological group (e.g., Lie groups, algebraic groups, profinite groups such as infinite Galois groups, etc...). In this case, it is not so meaningful to consider all representations of G which does not take into account the topology of G. If we really want to understand the topological nature of G, it is reasonable to consider, for example, continuous representations of G (i.e., require that $\pi\colon G \to \mathrm{Aut}_{\mathbb{C}}(V)$ or $\pi\colon G \times V \to V$ are continuous). But then, we also encounter a question "which kind of topology should we put on V?" If V if a finite-dimensional $\mathbb{C}$-vector space, then V has a natural topology. However, it is not the case when V is infinite dimensional or the coefficient field is general. In summary, to understand G well, it is important to think about the "appropriate class" of representations of G.

Example 1.8. Let $G := \mathfrak{S}_n$ be the symmetric group consisting of permutations of n letters. By putting $V := \mathbb{C}^{\oplus n} = \mathbb{C}e_1 \oplus \cdots \oplus \mathbb{C}e_n$, we can let $\mathfrak{S}_n$ naturally act on V by permuting $\{e_1, \ldots, e_n\}$. The resulting representation is called the *standard representation* of $\mathfrak{S}_n$ on V.

Example 1.9. Let $G := \mathrm{GL}_n(\mathbb{C})$. Then G naturally acts on $V := \mathbb{C}^{\oplus n}$. We call this representation the *standard representation* of $\mathrm{GL}_n(\mathbb{C})$.

1.2. **Irreducible representations.** Let us think about "classifying all representations" of a given group G. We start with the following notion:

Definition 1.10. Let (π, V) and (π', V') be representations of G.

(1) A *homomorphism* (or also called G-*homomorphism*) from (π, V) to (π', V') is a $\mathbb{C}$-vector space homomorphism $f\colon V \to V'$ which preserves G-actions, that is, f satisfies $f(\pi(g)(v)) = \pi'(g)(f(v))$ for any $g \in G$ and $v \in V$.

(2) An isomorphism (or also called G-*isomorphism*) from (π, V) to (π', V') is a homomorphism which is bijective. If there exists an isomorphism between (π, V) and (π', V'), we say that "(π, V) and (π', V') are isomorphic".

Looking at this definition, it should be reasonable to think that we may identify representations which are isomorphic to each other. So let us think about classifying all isomorphism classes of representations.

Definition 1.11. Let (π, V) be a representation of a group G.

(1) If a subspace $W \subset V$ is closed under the G-action on V, i.e., we have $\pi(g)(w) \in W$ for any $g \in G$ and $w \in W$, we say that W is a *subrepresentation* of (π, V).
(2) Let $W \subset V$ be a subrepresentation of (π, V). By letting $g \in G$ act on V/W by $g \cdot (v + W) := g \cdot v + W$ for $v \in V$, we obtain a representation of G on V/W. We call V/W the *quotient representation* of (π, V) by W.

Lemma 1.12. *Let $f\colon (\pi, V) \to (\pi', V')$ be a homomorphism of representations of G. Then we have the following:*

(1) $\mathrm{Ker}(f) \subset V$ *is a subrepresentation.*
(2) $\mathrm{Im}(f) \subset V'$ *is a subrepresentation.*
(3) *f induces an isomorphism $V/\mathrm{Ker}(f) \cong \mathrm{Im}(f)$ of representations of G.*

Proof. We first show (1). Let $v \in \mathrm{Ker}(f)$. Our task is to show that $\pi(g)(v) \in \mathrm{Ker}(f)$ for any $g \in G$. In other words, it suffices to show that $f(\pi(g)(v)) = 0$ for any $g \in G$. Since f is a homomorphism of representations and $v \in \mathrm{Ker}(f)$, we have

$$f(\pi(g)(v)) = \pi'(g)(f(v)) = \pi'(g)(0) = 0.$$

We next show (2). Let $v' \in \mathrm{Im}(f)$. Our task is to show that $\pi'(g)(v') \in \mathrm{Im}(f)$ for any $g \in G$. Since f is a homomorphism of representations, by writing $v' = f(v)$ with some $v \in V$, we have

$$\pi'(g)(v') = \pi'(g)(f(v)) = f(\pi(g)(v)) \in \mathrm{Im}(f).$$

Finally, by the first isomorphism theorem of linear algebra, we have an isomorphism $V/\mathrm{Ker}(f) \cong \mathrm{Im}(f)$ as $\mathbb{C}$-vector spaces. It can be easily checked that this isomorphism is also an isomorphism of representations of G. □

As this example shows, we can import various notions and results in linear algebra to representation theory.

Definition 1.13.

(1) Let (π, V) and (π', V') be representations of G. We define an representation $\pi \oplus \pi'$ of G on $V \oplus V'$ by

$$(\pi \oplus \pi')(g)(v + v') := \pi(g)(v) + \pi'(g)(v')$$

for any $g \in G$, $v \in V$, $v' \in V'$. We call $(\pi \oplus \pi', V \oplus V')$ the *direct sum* of (π, V) and (π', V').

(2) Let (π, V) and (π', V') be representations of G. We define an representation $\pi \otimes \pi'$ of G on $V \otimes V'$ by

$$(\pi \otimes \pi')(g)(v \otimes v') := \pi(g)(v) \otimes \pi'(g)(v')$$

for any $g \in G$, $v \in V$, $v' \in V'$. We call $(\pi \otimes \pi', V \otimes V')$ the *tensor product* of (π, V) and (π', V').

(3) Let (π, V) be a representation of G. We define the dual space $V^\vee := \mathrm{Hom}_{\mathbb{C}}(V, \mathbb{C})$ with an action $\pi^\vee$ of G by

$$\langle \pi^\vee(g)(v^\vee), v \rangle := \langle v^\vee, \pi(g^{-1})(v) \rangle$$

for any $g \in G$, $v \in V$, $v^\vee \in V^\vee$, where $\langle -, - \rangle$ denotes the natural pairing

$$V^\vee \times V \to \mathbb{C}\colon (v^\vee, v) \mapsto v^\vee(v).$$

We call $(\pi^\vee, V^\vee)$ the *dual representation* (or *contragredient representation*) of (π, V).

In a more sophisticated language, we can say that the category of representations of a group G has a structure of a "tensor category". Note that, if G is the trivial group $\{1\}$, then a representation of G is just a $\mathbb{C}$-vector space. Therefore, we may understand that representation theory is a generalization of linear algebra, or linear algebra is the simplest case of representation theory.

Now recall from linear algebra that an important theorem is that "any $\mathbb{C}$-vector space has a basis". In other words, this theorem says that any $\mathbb{C}$-vector space is isomorphic to a direct sum of copies of $\mathbb{C}$ (the trivial representation of the trivial group!). In particular, the isomorphism classes of $\mathbb{C}$-vector spaces are classified only by their dimensions.

Keeping this in mind, let us think about the classification of isomorphism classes of representations of a general group G. Firstly, we need to introduce "atoms" in representation theory, which cannot be decomposed any further like "$\mathbb{C}$" in linear algebra.

Definition 1.14. Let (π, V) be a representation of G. If $V \neq \{0\}$ and there does not exist a subrepresentation of V other than $\{0\}$ and V, we say that (π, V) is *irreducible*.

Ideally, we can hope to have the following kind of results for representations of a group G, which naturally generalizes the classification of $\mathbb{C}$-vector spaces in linear algebra:

(1) Any representation of G is a direct sum of irreducible representations ("*semisimplicity*").
(2) We can give a complete classification of the isomorphism classes of irreducible representations of G ("*classification of irreducible representations*").

If we can really establish such results, we see that the isomorphism classes of representations of G are exactly given by

$$\bigoplus_{\pi} \pi^{\oplus m_\pi},$$

where π runs over the isomorphism classes of irreducible representations of G (which can be further classified by (2)) and $m_\pi \in \mathbb{Z}_{\geq 0}$ is the *multiplicity* of π in the direct sum decomposition.

However, the reality is not so sweet; both (1) and (2) depend heavily on the given group G. Especially, (1) is not necessarily true, and (2) is a very difficult problem in general.

Now let us explain the highlight of the first part of this course, which is the representation theory of finite groups. The main point of representation theory of finite groups consists of the following:

- Any finite-dimensional representation of a finite group is semisimple, i.e., decomposes into the direct sum of irreducible representations (thus (1) of the above expectation is true).
- If a representation ρ of G and an irreducible representation π of G are give, we can establish a uniform manner of determining the multiplicity of π in the irreducible decomposition of ρ.

Here, we remark that the problem of classifying irreducible representations is still a difficult problem in general, even in the case of finite groups. For example,

it is known that irreducible representations of symmetric groups can be classified by Young diagrams, which are very explicit combinatorial objects. However, such a nice classification exists only for very few groups (probably), and basically depends on each individual group. In other words, we can interpret that the "general theory of representation theory of finite groups" is a claim that "classification of all representations can be completely reduced to classification of irreducible representations".

1.3. **Semisimplicity.**

Definition 1.15. Let (π, V) be a finite-dimensional representation of G. If the $\mathbb{C}$-vector space V is equipped with a Hermitian inner product $(-,-)\colon V \times V \to \mathbb{C}$ which is G-invariant, i.e., the equality

$$(\pi(g)(v), \pi(g)(v')) = (v, v')$$

is satisfied by any $g \in G$ and $v, v' \in V$, we say that (π, V) is a *unitary representation* of G.

Lemma 1.16. *Let G be a group and (π, V) be a unitary finite-dimensional representation of G. Then, for any subrepresentation $W \subset V$, there exists a subrepresentation $W' \subset V$ such that $V = W \oplus W'$.*

Proof. We let $W^\perp$ be the orthogonal complement of W in V with respect to the inner product $(-,-)$, i.e.,

$$W^\perp := \{v \in V \mid (v, w) = 0 \text{ for any } w \in W\}.$$

Then, since $(-,-)$ is an inner product, we have $V = W \oplus W^\perp$. Thus it is enough to check that $W^\perp$ is a subrepresentation. For any $v \in W^\perp$ and $g \in G$, the G-invariance of $(-,-)$ implies that

$$(\pi(g)(v), w) = (v, \pi(g^{-1})w) = 0$$

for any $w \in W$ (note that $\pi(g^{-1})w \in W$ since W is closed under G-action). In other words, $\pi(g)v$ again belongs to $W^\perp$. □

Lemma 1.17. *Any unitary finite-dimensional representation of a group G is semisimple.*

Proof. Let (π, V) be a unitary finite-dimensional representation of G. If V is already irreducible, then π itself gives an irreducible decomposition of π. Thus let us suppose that V is not irredcuible in the following. Then, by definition, there exists a non-zero proper subrepresentation $\{0\} \subsetneq W \subsetneq V$. By applying Lemma 1.16 to W, we can choose a subrepresentaion $W' \subset V$ such that $V = W \oplus W'$. Since the restriction of the inner product of V to W' gives an inner product of W', we see that W' is again a unitary finite-dimensional representation of G. By repeating this procedure, we eventually arrive at an irreducible decomposition of V since V is finite-dimensional. □

Proposition 1.18. *Any finite-dimensional representaion of a finite group G is semisimple.*

Proof. By Lemma 1.17, it is enough to prove that any finite-dimensional representation of a finite group G is automatically unitary. Let $(-,-)\colon V \times V \to \mathbb{C}$ be any

inner product (which may not necessarily be G-invariant). We modify $(-,-)$ by "averaging" it with respect to the G-action:

$$(-,-)'\colon V \times V \to \mathbb{C}; \quad (v,v')' := \frac{1}{|G|}\sum_{g\in G}(\pi(g)(v),\pi(g)(v')).$$

This is obviously again an inner product (positive-definite Hermitian inner product) of V. Moreover, it is G-invariant; indeed, for any $h \in G$ and $v, v' \in V$, we have

$$\begin{aligned}(\pi(h)(v),\pi(h)(v'))' &= \frac{1}{|G|}\sum_{g\in G}(\pi(gh)(v),\pi(gh)(v')) \\ &= \frac{1}{|G|}\sum_{g\in G}(\pi(g)(v),\pi(g)(v')) = (v,v')'.\end{aligned}$$

□

1.4. **Exercises.**

Exercise 1.1. Let G be a finite group. Prove that any irreducible representation of G is necessarily finite-dimensional.

Exercise 1.2. Let $G := \mathbb{Z}$. We consider the 2-dimensional representation (π, V) of G defined by $V = \mathbb{C}^{\oplus 2}$ and

$$\pi\colon \mathbb{Z} \to \mathrm{GL}_2(\mathbb{C})\colon n \mapsto \begin{pmatrix}1 & n\\ 0 & 1\end{pmatrix}.$$

Prove that π is not semisimple.

2. Lecture 2: Characters of finite-dimensional representations

2.1. Characters of representations.

Definition 2.1. Let (π, V) be a finite-dimensional representation of a group G. We define a function $\Theta_\pi \colon G \to \mathbb{C}$ by

$$\Theta_\pi \colon G \to \mathbb{C} \colon g \mapsto \mathrm{Tr}(\pi(g) \mid V).$$

We call Θ_π the *character* (or *trace character*) of (π, V).

Practically, the trace character can be computed by expressing $\pi(g)$ as a square matrix with respect to any $\mathbb{C}$-basis of V (recall that the trace of a $\mathbb{C}$-linear endomorphism is independent of the choice of a $\mathbb{C}$-basis).

Remark 2.2. Recall that we also call a 1-dimensional representation of G a "character" of G. So these terminologies are confusing, but I believe there will not be a serious problem. (If (π, V) is a 1-dimensional character, then its trace character $\Theta_\pi \colon G \to \mathbb{C}$ is nothing but $\pi \colon G \to \mathbb{C}^\times$ itself.)

Let us investigate basic properties of characters of representations.

Lemma 2.3. *Let (π, V) be an n-dimensional representation of a finite group G. Then we have the following:*

1. $\Theta_\pi(1) = n$.
2. $\Theta_\pi(g^{-1}) = \overline{\Theta_\pi(g)}$ *(the right-hand side denotes the complex conjugate).*
3. Θ_π *is conjugation-invariant, i.e., we have* $\Theta_\pi(hgh^{-1}) = \Theta_\pi(g)$ *for any* $g \in G$ *and* $h \in G$.

Proof. By choosing a $\mathbb{C}$-basis of V, let us think of π as a homomorphism $G \to \mathrm{GL}_n(\mathbb{C})$.

Since $\pi(1)$ is the identity matrix I_n of size n, its trace is given by n. Thus we get (1).

We check (2). Let $\alpha_1, \dots, \alpha_n$ be the set of eigenvalues of $\pi(g)$. Since G is a finite group, we have $g^r = 1$ for some $r \in \mathbb{Z}$. Then we have $\pi(g)^r = \pi(g^r) = I_n$. In particular, this implies that all $\alpha_1, \dots, \alpha_n$ are r-th roots of unity. On the other hand, since $\pi(g^{-1}) = \pi(g)^{-1}$, the eigenvalues of $\pi(g^{-1})$ are given by $\alpha_1^{-1}, \dots, \alpha_n^{-1}$. For any root of unity, its inverse is nothing but its complex conjugate. Hence we get

$$\Theta_\pi(g^{-1}) = \alpha_1^{-1} + \cdots + \alpha_n^{-1} = \overline{\alpha_1} + \cdots + \overline{\alpha_n} = \overline{\alpha_1 + \cdots + \alpha_n} = \overline{\Theta_\pi(g)}.$$

Finally, (3) follows from a general property of the trace of a matrix, that is, the trace is invariant under conjugation:

$$\Theta_\pi(hgh^{-1}) = \mathrm{Tr}(\pi(hgh^{-1})) = \mathrm{Tr}(\pi(h)\pi(g)\pi(h)^{-1}) = \mathrm{Tr}(\pi(g)) = \Theta_\pi(g).$$

□

Definition 2.4. For a group G, we call any function $f \colon G \to \mathbb{C}$ which is invariant under G-conjugation a *class function on* G. We write $C(G)$ for the set of class functions on G (note that $C(G)$ naturally has a structure of a $\mathbb{C}$-vector space).

Note that, with this definition, we may understand that Lemma 2.3 (3) asserts that the character Θ_π of any representation π of G belongs to $C(G)$.

Lemma 2.5. *Let (π, V) be a finite-dimensional representations of a group G. Then we have $\Theta_\pi(g) = \Theta_{\pi^\vee}(g^{-1})$ for any $g \in G$.*

Proof. Recall that, by definition, the contragredient representation $\pi^\vee$ is realized on the dual space $V^\vee$ by

$$\langle \pi^\vee(g)(v^\vee), v\rangle := \langle v^\vee, \pi(g^{-1})(v)\rangle.$$

The assertion immediately follows from this. □

Lemma 2.6. *Let (π_1, V_1) and (π_2, V_2) be finite-dimensional representations of a group G. Then we have $\Theta_{\pi_1\oplus\pi_2} = \Theta_{\pi_1} + \Theta_{\pi_2}$.*

Proof. This is almost obvious from the definition; if we fix $\mathbb{C}$-bases of V_1 and V_2 and express $\pi_1(g)$ and $\pi_2(g)$ as square matrices, then $(\pi_1 \oplus \pi_2)(g)$ is expressed as the block matrix with block-diagonal entries $\pi_1(g)$ and $\pi_2(g)$. □

Example 2.7. Let $G := \mathfrak{S}_3 = \{1, (1\,2), (2\,3), (3\,1), (1\,2\,3), (3\,2\,1)\}$. Let $(\pi, V := \mathbb{C}^{\oplus 3})$ be the standard representation of $\mathfrak{S}_3$. Recall that the conjugacy classes of the symmetric groups are classified by the "cycle types". In the case of $\mathfrak{S}_3$, we have 3 conjugacy classes:

$$\{1\}, \quad \{(1\,2), (2\,3), (3\,1)\}, \quad \{(1\,2\,3), (3\,2\,1)\}.$$

Let us compute the character Θ_π at each conjugacy class.

(1) If $g = 1$, then we have $\Theta_\pi(g) = \dim(V) = 3$.
(2) If $g = (1\,2)$, then the representation matrix of $\pi(g)$ is given by

$$\begin{pmatrix} & 1 & \\ 1 & & \\ & & 1 \end{pmatrix}.$$

Hence we get $\Theta_\pi(g) = 1$.
(3) If $g = (1\,2\,3)$, then the representation matrix of $\pi(g)$ is given by

$$\begin{pmatrix} & & 1 \\ 1 & & \\ & 1 & \end{pmatrix}.$$

Hence we get $\Theta_\pi(g) = 0$.

2.2. **Schur's lemma.** Let G be a finite group.

Lemma 2.8. *Let (π_1, V_1) and (π_2, V_2) be irreducible representations of G which are not isomorphic. Then $\mathrm{Hom}_G(V_1, V_2) = \{0\}$. In other words, any homomorphism $f\colon V_1 \to V_2$ as a representation of G is necessarily the zero map.*

Proof. Let $f\colon V_1 \to V_2$ be a homomorphism as representations of G. Then its kernel $\mathrm{Ker}(f)$ is a subrepresentation of V_1 (Lemma 1.12 (1)). Since V_1 is irreducible, we must have either $\mathrm{Ker}(f) = \{0\}$ or $\mathrm{Ker}(f) = V_1$. If $\mathrm{Ker}(f) = V_1$, then it means that $f = 0$. Thus let us suppose that $\mathrm{Ker}(f) = \{0\}$ for the sake of contradiction. By Lemma 1.12 (3), this implies that $V_1 \cong V_1/\mathrm{Ker}(f) \cong \mathrm{Im}(f) \subset V_2$. However, as $\mathrm{Im}(f)$ is also a subrepresentation of V_2 (Lemma 1.12 (2)) and nonzero, we necessarily have $\mathrm{Im}(f) = V_2$. Accordingly, we get $V_1 \cong V_2$, hence a contradiction. □

Theorem 2.9 (Schur's lemma)**.** *Let (π, V) be an irreducible finite-dimensional*[1] *representation of G. Then $\mathrm{End}_G(V) \cong \mathbb{C}$. In other words, any endomorphism $f\colon V \to V$ as a representation of G is necessarily of the form $f = \lambda \cdot \mathrm{id}_V$ with $\lambda \in \mathbb{C}$.*

[1]This finite-dimensionality condition is in fact unnecessary; see Exercise of Lecture 1.

Proof. Any $\mathbb{C}$-linear endomorphism of V of the form $\lambda \cdot \mathrm{id}_V$ is obviously an endomorphism of V as a representation of G. Hence our task is to show its converse.

Let $f\colon V \to V$ be a nonzero endomorphism of (π, V) as a representation of G. Let $v \in V \smallsetminus \{0\}$ be an eigenvector with eigenvalue $\lambda \in \mathbb{C}$, i.e., $f(v) = \lambda \cdot v$. Then $f - \lambda \cdot \mathrm{id}_V \in \mathrm{End}_{\mathbb{C}}(V)$ again belongs to $\in \mathrm{End}_G(V)$. Since the kernel of any homomorphism as G-representations is a subrepresentation (Lemma 1.12 (2)), we see that $\mathrm{Ker}(f - \lambda \cdot \mathrm{id}_V) \subset V$ is a subrepresentation. Since V is irreducible and $\mathrm{Ker}(f - \lambda \cdot \mathrm{id}_V) \neq 0$ (as it at least contains $v \neq 0$), we necessarily have $\mathrm{Ker}(f - \lambda \cdot \mathrm{id}_V) = V$. In other words, $f = \lambda \cdot \mathrm{id}_V$. □

Corollary 2.10. *Let (π_1, V_1) and (π_2, V_2) be irreducible representations of a group G. For any $f \in \mathrm{Hom}_{\mathbb{C}}(V_1, V_2)$, we define $f^0 \in \mathrm{Hom}_{\mathbb{C}}(V_1, V_2)$ by*

$$f^0 := \frac{1}{|G|} \sum_{g \in G} \pi_2(g)^{-1} \circ f \circ \pi_1(g).$$

Then we have

$$f^0 = \begin{cases} 0 & \text{if } \pi_1 \ncong \pi_2, \\ \frac{\mathrm{Tr}(f)}{\dim(V)} \cdot \mathrm{id}_V & \text{if } \pi_1 \cong \pi_2, \end{cases}$$

where, in the second case, we assume that $\pi_1 = \pi_2$ and $V_1 = V_2 =: V$.

Proof. We note that f^0 is a homomorphism as representations of G. Indeed, for any $h \in G$, we have

$$\begin{aligned} f^0 \circ \pi_1(h) &= \frac{1}{|G|} \sum_{g \in G} \pi_2(g)^{-1} \circ f \circ \pi_1(g) \circ \pi_1(h) \\ &= \frac{1}{|G|} \sum_{g \in G} \pi_2(g)^{-1} \circ f \circ \pi_1(gh) \\ &= \frac{1}{|G|} \sum_{g \in G} \pi_2(gh^{-1})^{-1} \circ f \circ \pi_1(g) \\ &= \frac{1}{|G|} \sum_{g \in G} \pi_2(h) \circ \pi_2(g)^{-1} \circ f \circ \pi_1(g) = \pi_2(h) \circ f^0, \end{aligned}$$

where, in the third equality, we replaced gh with g. Therefore, by Lemma 2.8 and Theorem 2.9, we get

$$f^0 = \begin{cases} 0 & \text{if } \pi_1 \ncong \pi_2, \\ \lambda \cdot \mathrm{id}_V & \text{if } \pi_1 \cong \pi_2, \end{cases}$$

with some scalar $\lambda \in \mathbb{C}$. Thus our remaining task is to determine the scalar λ when $\pi_1 \cong \pi_2$. We may assume $\pi_1 = \pi_2$ and write π for $\pi_1 = \pi_2$. Then

$$\mathrm{Tr}(f^0) = \frac{1}{|G|} \sum_{g \in G} \mathrm{Tr}(\pi(g)^{-1} \circ f \circ \pi(g)) = \frac{1}{|G|} \sum_{g \in G} \mathrm{Tr}(f) = \mathrm{Tr}(f).$$

As $f^0 = \lambda \cdot \mathrm{id}_V$, we also have $\mathrm{Tr}(f^0) = \lambda \cdot \dim(V)$. Hence we get $\lambda = \mathrm{Tr}(f)/\dim(V)$. □

Let us furthermore rewrite this corollary in terms of matrix representations. By fixing $\mathbb{C}$-bases of V_1 and V_2, we write $\pi_2(g^{-1})$ and $\pi_1(g)$ as

$$(\pi_2(g^{-1})_{ij})_{ij} \quad \text{and} \quad (\pi_1(g)_{pq})_{pq},$$

respectively.

Corollary 2.11. (1) *If $\pi_1 \not\cong \pi_2$, then, for any i, j, p, q,*

$$\sum_{g \in G} \pi_2(g^{-1})_{ij} \cdot \pi_1(g)_{pq} = 0.$$

(2) *If $\pi_1 \cong \pi_2$ (assume $\pi_1 = \pi_2$), then, for any i, j, p, q,*

$$\sum_{g \in G} \pi_2(g^{-1})_{ij} \cdot \pi_1(g)_{pq} = \begin{cases} \frac{|G|}{\dim(V)} & \text{if } i = q \text{ and } j = p, \\ 0 & \text{otherwise.} \end{cases}$$

Proof. Let us take any $f \in \mathrm{Hom}_{\mathbb{C}}(V_1, V_2)$ and write it as $f = (f_{kl})_{kl}$ using the fixed $\mathbb{C}$-bases of V_1 and V_2. Then each entry of the representation matrix $(f^0_{iq})_{iq}$ of f^0 is given by:

$$f^0_{iq} = \frac{1}{|G|} \sum_{g \in G} \sum_{j,p} \pi_2(g^{-1})_{ij} \cdot f_{jp} \cdot \pi_1(g)_{pq}.$$

We first consider the case where $\pi_1 \not\cong \pi_2$. In this case, by the above corollary, we have $(f^0_{iq})_{iq} = 0$ for any $f = (f_{kl})_{kl}$. Hence, the above equality implies that

$$\frac{1}{|G|} \sum_{g \in G} \sum_{j,p} \pi_2(g^{-1})_{ij} \cdot f_{jp} \cdot \pi_1(g)_{pq} = 0$$

for each i, q (for any $f = (f_{kl})_{kl}$). Since f can vary arbitrary, by looking at the coefficients of each f_{jp} on the both hand sides of this equality, we get

$$\sum_{g \in G} \pi_2(g^{-1})_{ij} \cdot \pi_1(g)_{pq} = 0$$

for each i, j, p, q.

We next consider the case where $\pi_1 = \pi_2$. In this case, for any $f = (f_{kl})_{kl}$, f^0 is represented by the scalar matrix with diagonal entries $\mathrm{Tr}(f)/\dim(V)$. In other words, we have

$$\frac{1}{|G|} \sum_{g \in G} \sum_{j,p} \pi_2(g^{-1})_{ij} \cdot f_{jp} \cdot \pi_1(g)_{pq} = \begin{cases} \frac{1}{\dim(V)}(f_{11} + \cdots + f_{nn}) & i = q, \\ 0 & i \neq q, \end{cases}$$

where $n = \dim(V)$. Therefore, we get

$$\sum_{g \in G} \pi_2(g^{-1})_{ij} \cdot \pi_1(g)_{pq} = \begin{cases} \frac{|G|}{\dim(V)} & i = q \quad \text{and} \quad j = p, \\ 0 & \text{otherwise.} \end{cases}$$

□

2.3. **Orthogonality relation.** In the following, we continue to assume that G is a finite group. Also, by a "representation of G", we always mean a finite-dimensional representation. Let $\mathbb{C}[G]$ denote the space of $\mathbb{C}$-valued functions on G. We define an inner product $(-,-)_G$ on $\mathbb{C}[G]$ by

$$(f_1, f_2)_G := \frac{1}{|G|} \sum_{g \in G} f_1(g) \cdot \overline{f_2(g)}$$

for any $f_1, f_2 \in \mathbb{C}[G]$. (It is obvious that this indeed defines an inner product; $(-,-)_G$ is $\mathbb{C}$-linear in f_1, anti-$\mathbb{C}$-linear in f_2, and satisfies $(f, f)_G > 0$ for any nonzero f.) As long as G is fixed and the choice of G is clear from the context, we often simply write $(-,-)$ instead of $(-,-)_G$.

Theorem 2.12. *Let (π_1, V_1) and (π_2, V_2) be irreducible representations of G. Then we have*

$$(\Theta_{\pi_1}, \Theta_{\pi_2}) = \begin{cases} 0 & \text{if } \pi_1 \not\cong \pi_2, \\ 1 & \text{if } \pi_1 \cong \pi_2. \end{cases}$$

Proof. By fixing $\mathbb{C}$-bases of V_1 and V_2, we write $\pi_2(g^{-1})$ and $\pi_1(g)$ as

$$(\pi_2(g^{-1})_{ij})_{ij} \quad \text{and} \quad (\pi_1(g)_{pq})_{pq},$$

respectively. Then we have

$$\begin{aligned}(\Theta_{\pi_1}, \Theta_{\pi_2}) &= \frac{1}{|G|} \sum_{g \in G} \Theta_{\pi_1}(g) \cdot \overline{\Theta_{\pi_2}(g)} = \frac{1}{|G|} \sum_{g \in G} \Theta_{\pi_1}(g) \cdot \Theta_{\pi_2}(g^{-1}) \\ &= \frac{1}{|G|} \sum_{g \in G} \Big(\sum_i \pi_1(g)_{ii} \Big) \cdot \Big(\sum_p \pi_2(g^{-1})_{pp} \Big)\end{aligned}$$

If $\pi_1 \not\cong \pi_2$, then Corollary 2.11 (1) immediately implies that this is equal to 0. Thus let us suppose that $\pi_1 = \pi_2$. Again by Corollary 2.11 (2), we get

$$\frac{1}{|G|} \sum_{g \in G} \Big(\sum_i \pi_1(g)_{ii} \Big) \cdot \Big(\sum_p \pi_2(g^{-1})_{pp} \Big) = \frac{1}{|G|} \sum_i \frac{|G|}{\dim(V)} = 1.$$

□

Corollary 2.13. *Let (π, V) be a representation of G and let $\pi = \pi_1 \oplus \cdots \oplus \pi_r$ be a decomposition into irreducible representations (recall that there always exists such a decomposition by Proposition 1.18). Then, for any irreducible representation π_0 of G, the number of π_i's which are isomorphic to π_0 is given by $(\Theta_\pi, \Theta_{\pi_0})$. In particular, a decomposition of any representation G into irreducible representations is always unique up to permutation and isomoprhism of irreducible factors.*

Proof. Since $\Theta_\pi = \Theta_{\pi_1} + \cdots + \Theta_{\pi_r}$, we have

$$(\Theta_\pi, \Theta_{\pi_0}) = (\Theta_{\pi_1} + \cdots + \Theta_{\pi_r}, \Theta_{\pi_0}) = \sum_{i=1}^{r} (\Theta_{\pi_i}, \Theta_{\pi_0}) = |\{1 \leq i \leq r \mid \pi_i \cong \pi_0\}|$$

by Theorem 2.12. □

Corollary 2.14. *Let(π, V) and (π', V') be representations of G. Then $\pi \cong \pi'$ if and only if $\Theta_\pi = \Theta_{\pi'}$.*

Proof. The only if direction is trivial, so let us prove the if direction. Let us take irreducible decompositions of π and π':

$$\pi \cong \pi_1 \oplus \cdots \oplus \pi_r \quad \text{and} \quad \pi' \cong \pi'_1 \oplus \cdots \oplus \pi'_s.$$

Then, for each irreducible representation π_0 of G, Corollary 2.13 implies that

$$|\{1 \leq i \leq r \mid \pi_i \cong \pi_0\}| = (\Theta_\pi, \Theta_{\pi_0}) = (\Theta_{\pi'}, \Theta_{\pi_0}) = |\{1 \leq j \leq s \mid \pi'_j \cong \pi_0\}|.$$

This shows that the above decompositions of π and π' coincide up to permutations of indices and up to isomorphism. □

At this point, we can clearly understand why the notion of the character of a representation is important in representation theory of finite groups. Any (finite-dimensional) representation of a finite group is uniquely determined by its character, so *characters tell all.*

Another important point is that the character of a representation is a complex-valued function on the group, which is a much more concrete object to work with. Representations have the freedom to "move": two isomorphic representations can be realized on completely different vector spaces. This freedom makes representation theory so flexible and useful, but, at the same time, also makes things more complicated. For example, when we want to compare two different representations of a group, we first must think about how to relate those two totally different (seemingly) spaces. On the other hand, by passing to their characters, the problem of comparing representations is reduced to the much more concrete problem of comparing complex-valued functions.

Corollary 2.15. *Let π be a representation of G. Then π is irreducible if and only if $(\Theta_\pi, \Theta_\pi) = 1$.*

Proof. We consider the irreducible decomposition

$$\pi \cong \bigoplus_{\pi_0} \pi_0^{\oplus m_{\pi_0}},$$

where the sum runs over isomorphism classes of irreducible representations of G. Then, by Corollary 2.13, we have

$$(\Theta_\pi, \Theta_\pi) = \sum_{\pi_0} (m_{\pi_0} \cdot \Theta_{\pi_0}, m_{\pi_0} \cdot \Theta_{\pi_0}) = \sum_{\pi_0} m_{\pi_0}^2.$$

Hence $(\Theta_\pi, \Theta_\pi) = 1$ if and only if $\sum_{\pi_0} m_{\pi_0}^2 = 1$, which is equivalent to that only one π_0 appears in the irreducible decomposition of π, whose multiplicity $m_{\pi_0} = 1$. □

Let us also present a practical consequence of our discussions so far:

Corollary 2.16. *For any two finite-dimensional representations (π_1, V_1) and (π_2, V_2) of G, we have*

$$\dim \mathrm{Hom}_G(\pi_1, \pi_2) = (\Theta_{\pi_1}, \Theta_{\pi_2}).$$

Proof. By taking irreducible decompositions of π_1 and π_2, the identity follows from Theorems 2.9 and 2.12. □

Example 2.17. Let us consider the standard representation (π, V) of $G := \mathfrak{S}_3$ again (see Example 2.7). Recall that we have three conjugacy classes of G:

$$\{1\}, \quad \{(1\,2), (2\,3), (3\,1)\}, \quad \{(1\,2\,3), (3\,2\,1)\}.$$

The characters $\Theta_\pi(g)$ on these conjugacy classes are given by 3, 1, 0, respectively. Therefore, we get

$$(\Theta_\pi, \Theta_\pi) = \frac{1}{|\mathfrak{S}_3|} \sum_{g \in \mathfrak{S}_3} \Theta_\pi(g) \cdot \overline{\Theta_\pi(g)} = \frac{1}{6}(1 \cdot 3^2 + 3 \cdot 1^2 + 2 \cdot 0^2) = 2.$$

Hence, at least Corollary 2.15 implies that π is not irreducible. More precisely, if we let $\pi \cong \bigoplus_{\pi_0} \pi_0^{\oplus m_{\pi_0}}$ be the irreducible decomposition, then we have

$$\sum_{\pi_0} m_{\pi_0}^2 = 2.$$

Thus the only possibility is that we have exactly two irreducible representations appearing in the decomposition of π and that the multiplicities are both 1.

Furthermore, if we write $V = \mathbb{C}e_1 \oplus \mathbb{C}e_2 \oplus \mathbb{C}e_3$, then the subspace $\mathbb{C}(e_1 + e_2 + e_3)$ is a subrepresentation of V, on which G acts trivially. Therefore, we see

that π decomposes into the sum of the trivial representation and a 2-dimensional irreducible representation, both of which have multiplicity 1. The 2-dimensional irreducible subrepresentation can be concretely given by $\{x_1e_1 + x_2e_2 + x_3e_3 \in V \mid x_1 + x_2 + x_3 = 0\}$.

2.4. **The case of abelian groups.**

Proposition 2.18. *Let G be a finite abelian group. Then any irreducible representation of G is 1-dimensional.*

Proof. Let (π, V) be an irreducible representation of G. If we fix $g \in G$, then $\pi(g) \in \mathrm{End}_{\mathbb{C}}(V)$ is in fact an endomoprhism as G-representations. Indeed, for any $h \in G$, we have $\pi(g) \circ \pi(h) = \pi(gh) = \pi(hg) = \pi(h) \circ \pi(g)$. By Schur's lemma (Theorem 2.9), this implies that $\pi(g) = z_g \cdot \mathrm{id}_V$ for some $z_g \in \mathbb{C}^\times$. Namely, any $g \in G$ acts on V via a scalar multiplilcation. Therefore, so that V is irreducible, we necessarily have that V is 1-dimensional. □

2.5. **Exercises.** In the following exercises, "to describe the irreducible decomposition" means to write a given representation π as

$$\pi \cong \bigoplus_{\pi_0} \pi_0^{m_{\pi_0}},$$

where the sum is over isomorphism classes of irreducible representations, with explicitly determining each m_{π_0}. (You do not have to find an explicit description of each subspace π_0 in π.)

Exercise 2.1.
(1) Let (π_1, V_1) and (π_2, V_2) be finite-dimensional representations of a group G. Prove that $\Theta_{\pi_1 \otimes \pi_2} = \Theta_{\pi_1} \cdot \Theta_{\pi_2}$.
(2) Let (π, V) be the 2-dimensional irreducible representation of $\mathfrak{S}_3$ considered in Example 2.17. Describe the irreducible decomposition of $\pi^{\otimes 2} = \pi \otimes \pi$.

Exercise 2.2. Let X be the set of subsets of $\{1, 2, 3, 4\}$ consisting of two elements:

$$X = \{\{1, 2\}, \{1, 3\}, \{1, 4\}, \{2, 3\}, \{2, 4\}, \{3, 4\}\}.$$

Then the permutation group $\mathfrak{S}_4$ naturally acts on X. Accordingly, if we let $V := \bigoplus_{x \in X} \mathbb{C}e_x$ (the $\mathbb{C}$-vector space with basis labeled by elements of X), we get a representation (π, V) of $\mathfrak{S}_4$. Describe the irreducible decomposition of π.

Exercise 2.3. Consider the dihedral group of order 10:

$$D_{10} := \langle r, s \mid r^5 = s^2 = 1,\ srs = r^{-1} \rangle.$$

The group D_{10} naturally acts on the set of five vertices of the pentagon. By identifying these vertices with the five standard basis vectors of $\mathbb{C}^5$, we obtain a representation $(\pi, \mathbb{C}^5)$ of D_{10}. Describe the irreducible decomposition of π.

3. Lecture 3: Basic results on irreducible representations

3.1. **Square-sum formula for dimensions.** Let G be a finite group. Recall that $\mathbb{C}[G]$ denotes the $\mathbb{C}$-vector space of $\mathbb{C}$-valued functions on G. We let G act on $\mathbb{C}[G]$ by, for $f \in \mathbb{C}[G]$ and $g \in G$,

$$(R(g) \cdot f)(x) := f(xg).$$

It is not difficult to see that this is indeed a well-defined group action, hence defines a representation $(R, \mathbb{C}[G])$ of G.

Definition 3.1. We call $(R, \mathbb{C}[G])$ the *regular representation* (or *right regular representation*) of G.

The irreducible decomposition of $(R, \mathbb{C}[G])$ has a particularly interesting feature as we will examine from now on.

First, note that $\mathbb{C}[G]$ has the following $\mathbb{C}$-basis:

$$\{\mathbb{1}_g \mid g \in G\},$$

where $\mathbb{1}_g$ denotes the characteristic function of $\{g\} \subset G$, i.e.,

$$\mathbb{1}_g(x) = \begin{cases} 1 & \text{if } x = g, \\ 0 & \text{if } x \neq g. \end{cases}$$

(Hence, in particular, $\dim \mathbb{C}[G] = |G|$.)

Lemma 3.2. *The character Θ_R of the regular representation R of G is given by*

$$\Theta_R(g) = \begin{cases} |G| & \text{if } g = 1, \\ 0 & \text{if } g \neq 1. \end{cases}$$

Proof. Since R is $|G|$-dimensional, we have $\Theta_R(1) = \mathrm{Tr}(R(1)) = |G|$.

On the other hand, for any $g \in G$ and $x \in G$, we have

$$R(g)(\mathbb{1}_x) = \mathbb{1}_{xg^{-1}}.$$

Hence, whenever $g \neq 1$, the representation matrix of $R(g)$ with respect to the $\mathbb{C}$-basis $\{\mathbb{1}_g \mid g \in G\}$ is given by a permutation matrix whose diagonal entries are all zero. In particular, we have $\Theta_R(g) = \mathrm{Tr}(R(g)) = 0$. □

Proposition 3.3. *If (π, V) is an irreducible representation of G, then π is contained in the regular representation R with multiplicity $\dim \pi$. Especially, the irreducible decomposition of R is given by*

$$R \cong \bigoplus_{\pi} \pi^{\oplus \dim \pi},$$

where the sum is over all isomorphism classes of irreducible representations of G.

Proof. Recall that (Corollary 2.13) the multiplicity of π in R is given by the inner product of their characters (Θ_π, Θ_R). By Lemma 3.2,

$$(\Theta_\pi, \Theta_R) = \frac{1}{|G|} \sum_{g \in G} \Theta_\pi(g) \cdot \overline{\Theta_R(g)} = \frac{1}{|G|} \dim \pi \cdot |G| = \dim \pi.$$

□

Corollary 3.4. *There are only finitely many isomorphism classes of irreducible representations of G. More precisely, we have*

$$\sum_{\pi}(\dim \pi)^2 = |G|,$$

where the sum is over the isomorphism classes of irreducible representations of G.

Proof. By Proposition 3.3, we obtain

$$|G| = \dim R = \sum_{\pi} \dim(\pi^{\oplus \dim \pi}) = \sum_{\pi}(\dim \pi)^2.$$

□

3.2. **Number of irreducible representations.** Recall that we call an element $f \in \mathbb{C}[G]$ which is G-conjugation-invariant a *class function*. We write $C(G)$ for the $\mathbb{C}$-subspace of $\mathbb{C}[G]$ of class functions.

$$C(G) := \{f \in \mathbb{C}[G] \mid f \text{ is } G\text{-conjugation-invariant}\} \subset \mathbb{C}[G].$$

Also recall that the character of a representation of G is always a class function. Furthermore, the orthogonality relation (Theorem 2.12) shows that the characters of irreducible representations of G are orthonormal to each other with respect to the inner product on $C(G) \subset \mathbb{C}[G]$. Our aim here is to show the following:

Theorem 3.5. *The characters of irreducible representations of G form an orthonormal basis of $C(G)$. More precisely, if we let $\{\pi_1, \dots, \pi_r\}$ be a set of representatives of isomorphism classes of irreducible representations of G, then $\{\Theta_{\pi_1}, \dots, \Theta_{\pi_r}\}$ is a $\mathbb{C}$-basis of $C(G)$ satisfying*

$$(\Theta_{\pi_i}, \Theta_{\pi_j}) = \delta_{ij},$$

where δ_{ij} is the Kronecker delta.

Before we prove this theorem, we introduce some notation. Suppose that (π, V) is a representation of G. Then, for any class function $f \in C(G)$, we define an endomorphism $\pi(f) \in \mathrm{End}_{\mathbb{C}}(V)$ by

$$\pi(f) := \sum_{g \in G} f(g) \cdot \pi(g)$$

("averaging π with weight f").

Lemma 3.6. *With the above notation, we have $\pi(f) \in \mathrm{End}_G(V)$, i.e., $\pi(f)$ is an endomorphism of V as a representation of G.*

Proof. It suffices to show that, for any $h \in G$, we have $\pi(f) \circ \pi(h) = \pi(h) \circ \pi(f)$, or equivalently, $\pi(f) = \pi(h) \circ \pi(f) \circ \pi(h)^{-1}$. We have

$$\begin{aligned}
\pi(h) \circ \pi(f) \circ \pi(h)^{-1} &= \sum_{g \in G} f(g) \cdot \pi(h) \circ \pi(g) \circ \pi(h)^{-1} \\
&= \sum_{g \in G} f(g) \cdot \pi(hgh^{-1}) \\
&= \sum_{g \in G} f(h^{-1}gh) \cdot \pi(g) = \sum_{g \in G} f(g) \cdot \pi(g) = \pi(f),
\end{aligned}$$

where we replaced hgh^{-1} with g in the third equality and used the G-conjugation-invariance of f in the fourth equality. □

Proof of Theorem 3.5. We already saw that $\{\Theta_{\pi_1}, \dots, \Theta_{\pi_r}\}$ is an orthonormal subset. Thus our remaining task is to prove that $\{\Theta_{\pi_1}, \dots, \Theta_{\pi_r}\}$ is a $\mathbb{C}$-basis of $C(G)$. To show this, it is enough to check that any $f \in C(G)$ satisfying $(f, \Theta_{\pi_i}) = 0$ for any $1 \leq i \leq r$ is necessarily zero.

Let $f \in C(G)$ be such a function. For each irreducible representation (π_i, V_i), let us compute the endomorphism $\pi_i(f) \in \mathrm{End}_G(V_i)$. By Schur's lemma (Theorem 2.9), $\pi_i(f) = c_i \cdot \mathrm{id}_{V_i}$ with some constant $c_i \in \mathbb{C}$. By the definition of the operator $\pi_i(f)$, we have

$$\mathrm{Tr}(\pi_i(f)) = \sum_{g \in G} f(g) \cdot \mathrm{Tr}(\pi_i(g)) = |G| \cdot (f, \Theta_{\pi_i^\vee})$$

(recall that $\Theta_{\pi_i^\vee}(g) = \overline{\Theta_{\pi_i}(g)}$). On the other hand, we also have $\mathrm{Tr}(\pi_i(f)) = c_i \cdot \dim(V_i)$. This implies that

$$c_i = \frac{|G|}{\dim(V_i)} (f, \Theta_{\pi_i^\vee}).$$

Now we use the assumption on f, i.e., $(f, \Theta_{\pi_i}) = 0$ for all i's. By noting that $\pi_i^\vee$ is irreducible, we see that $c_i = 0$ for all i's. Hence, $\pi_i(f) = 0$ for all i's. Since the regular representation $(R, \mathbb{C}[G])$ of G has the decomposition (Proposition 3.3)

$$R \cong \bigoplus_{\pi_i} \pi_i^{\oplus \dim \pi_i},$$

we also know that $R(f) = 0$. However, by the definition of $R(f)$, we have

$$R(f)(\mathbb{1}_1) = \sum_{g \in G} f(g) \cdot R(g)(\mathbb{1}_1) = \sum_{g \in G} f(g) \cdot (\mathbb{1}_{g^{-1}}).$$

Especially, the equality $R(f)(\mathbb{1}_1) = 0$ implies that $f(g) = 0$ at all $g \in G$. □

Corollary 3.7. *The number of isomorphism classes of irreducible representations of G is equal to the number of conjugacy classes of G.*

Proof. By Theorem 3.5, the number of isomorphism classes of irreducible representations of G is given by $\dim C(G)$. If we let $\{C_1, \dots, C_r\}$ be the set of all conjugacy classes of G, then their characteristic functions

$$\{\mathbb{1}_{C_1}, \dots, \mathbb{1}_{C_r}\}$$

form a $\mathbb{C}$-basis of $C(G)$. In particular, $\dim C(G)$ is equal to the number of conjugacy classes of G. □

Recall that any irreducible representation of a finite abelian group is 1-dimensional (Proposition 2.18). Using the facts we proved so far, we can upgrade Proposition 2.18 as follows:

Proposition 3.8. *Let G be a finite group. Then G is abelian if and only if any irreducible representation of G is 1-dimensional.*

Proof. Let G be a finite group of order n.

The "only if" part was already proved in Proposition 2.18, but here let us also see how it follows from our discussion in this subsection. Suppose that G is abelian. Then, for any $g \in G$, the conjugacy class containing g is the singleton $\{g\}$:

$$\{xgx^{-1} \in G \mid x \in G\} = \{g\}.$$

Hence we have n conjugacy classes of G. If we let $\pi_1, \dots, \pi_n$ be the irreducible representations, then Corollaries 3.4 and 3.7 imply that

$$n = (\dim \pi_1)^2 + \cdots + (\dim \pi_n)^2.$$

Hence we must have $\dim \pi_1 = \cdots = \dim \pi_n = 1$.

Let us show the "if" part. Let r be the number of conjugacy classes in G. To show that G is abelian, it suffices to check that $r = n$. Let $\pi_1, \dots, \pi_r$ be the set of irreducible representations of G, which must be all 1-dimensional by assumption. Then Corollary 3.4 implies that

$$n = (\dim \pi_1)^2 + \cdots + (\dim \pi_r)^2 = r.$$

This completes the proof. □

Example 3.9. Let us classify the irreducible representations of $\mathfrak{S}_3$. Since $\mathfrak{S}_3$ has three conjugacy classes, we must have three irreducible representations up to isomorphism by Corollary 3.7. Let π_1, π_2, π_3 be three (isomorphism classes of) irreducible representations. By Corollary 3.4, we have

$$|\mathfrak{S}_3| = 6 = (\dim \pi_1)^2 + (\dim \pi_2)^2 + (\dim \pi_3)^2.$$

The only possible triple of positive integers whose square sum equals 6 is $(1, 1, 2)$ up to permutation; thus there are two 1-dimensional irreducible representations and one 2-dimensional representation. These can be explicitly realized as follows:

- The trivial representation is obviously a 1-dimensional irreducible representation of $\mathfrak{S}_3$.
- The sign character $\mathrm{sgn}\colon \mathfrak{S}_3 \to \{\pm 1\} \subset \mathbb{C}^\times$ is also a 1-dimensional irreducible representation of $\mathfrak{S}_3$, which is obviously not equal to the trivial representation. Here, recall that sgn is given by

$$\mathrm{sgn}(1) = 1,$$
$$\mathrm{sgn}((12)) = \mathrm{sgn}((23)) = \mathrm{sgn}((31)) = -1,$$
$$\mathrm{sgn}((123)) = \mathrm{sgn}((132)) = 1.$$

- Recall from Example 2.17 that the 3-dimensional standard representation (π, V) of $\mathfrak{S}_3$ decomposes into the sum of two irreducible representations, one of which is the trivial representation (write $\mathbb{1}$). Hence, the quotient representation $\pi/\mathbb{1}$ gives a 2-dimensional irreducible representation of $\mathfrak{S}_3$.

3.3. **Exercises.**

Exercise 3.1. Let G be the alternating group $\mathfrak{A}_5$ on five letters, i.e,

$$\mathfrak{A}_5 := \mathrm{Ker}(\mathrm{sgn}\colon \mathfrak{S}_5 \to \{\pm 1\}).$$

Determine the dimensions of all irreducible representations of G.

Exercise 3.2. Let $G := \mathfrak{S}_4$. We consider the following 3-dimensional subrepresentation of the permutation representation of G:

$$W := \{(x_1, x_2, x_3, x_4) \in \mathbb{C}^{\oplus 4} \mid x_1 + x_2 + x_3 + x_4 = 0\}.$$

Let $\mathrm{sgn}\colon \mathfrak{S}_4 \to \{\pm 1\}$ denote the sign character of G.

(1) Prove that W and $W \otimes \mathrm{sgn}$ are irreducible and are not isomorphic to each other.
(2) Determine the dimensions of all irreducible representations of G.

Exercise 3.3. Let G be the quaternion group Q_8, i.e.,

$$G := Q_8 := \{\pm 1, \pm i, \pm j, \pm k\}, \qquad i^2 = j^2 = k^2 = ijk = -1.$$

(1) Find all 1-dimensional representations of G.
(2) Determine the dimensions of all irreducible representations of G.

4. Lecture 4: Induced representations

4.1. **Induced representations.** Let G be a group and H its subgroup. If a representation (π, V) of G is given, then we may obtain a representation of H by restricting π to H. The resulting representation is called the *restriction* of (π, V), and denoted by $(\pi|_H, V)$ or $(\mathrm{Res}^G_H \pi, V)$.

What we want to investigate today is the "converse" of this procedure. That is, let us suppose that a representation (ρ, W) of H is given first. Then, is there any natural way to get a representation of G using it? The answer is yes; it is called the *induction* explained below.

We consider the space $\mathrm{Ind}^G_H W$ of W-valued functions satisfying the "left-(H, ρ)-invariance condition" as follows:

$$\mathrm{Ind}^G_H W := \{f \colon G \to W \mid f(hx) = \rho(h)(f(x)) \text{ for any } x \in G, h \in H\}.$$

We define an action $\mathrm{Ind}^G_H \rho$ of G on $\mathrm{Ind}^G_H W$ by the right-translation of W-valued functions, i.e., for any $g \in G$ and $f \in \mathrm{Ind}^G_H W$, we define $g \cdot f \in \mathrm{Ind}^G_H W$ by

$$(g \cdot f)(x) := f(xg).$$

(To be more precise, $g \cdot f$ should be written as $(\mathrm{Ind}^G_H \rho)(g)(f)$, but we avoid it since it is too heavy.) Then we obtain a representation $(\mathrm{Ind}^G_H \rho, \mathrm{Ind}^G_H W)$ of G. We call $(\mathrm{Ind}^G_H \rho, \mathrm{Ind}^G_H W)$ the *induction* of (ρ, W) from H to G.

Example 4.1. Let G be a finite group and $H := \{1\}$. We take a representation (ρ, W) of H to be the trivial representation $(\mathbb{1}, \mathbb{C})$. In this case, the space $\mathrm{Ind}^G_H W$ simply equals the $\mathbb{C}$-vector space of all $\mathbb{C}$-valued functions on G, i.e., $\mathbb{C}[G]$. Therefore, the induction $(\mathrm{Ind}^G_{\{1\}} \mathbb{1}, \mathrm{Ind}^G_{\{1\}} \mathbb{C})$ is nothing but the right regular representation of G on $\mathbb{C}[G]$.

Lemma 4.2. *We have* $\dim(\mathrm{Ind}^G_H W) = [G : H] \cdot \dim W$.

Proof. We put $n := \dim W$ and choose a $\mathbb{C}$-basis $\{v_1, \dots, v_n\}$ of W. We fix a set of representatives $\{g_1, \dots, g_r\}$ of $H\backslash G$. For each g_i and v_i, we define a W-valued function $f_{i,j} \colon G \to W$ by

$$f_{i,j}(g) := \begin{cases} \rho(h)v_i & \text{if } g = hg_i \text{ for some } h \in H, \\ 0 & \text{otherwise.} \end{cases}$$

Then it is easy to see that this is an element of $\mathrm{Ind}^G_H W$ and also that $\{f_{i,j}\}_{i,j}$ forms a $\mathbb{C}$-basis of $\mathrm{Ind}^G_H W$. In particular, $\dim(\mathrm{Ind}^G_H W) = [G : H] \cdot \dim W$. □

4.2. **Frobenius character formula.**

Theorem 4.3 (Frobenius character formula)**.** *Let G be a finite group and H a subgroup. Let (ρ, W) be a finite-dimensional representation of H. We put $(\pi, V) := (\mathrm{Ind}^G_H \rho, \mathrm{Ind}^G_H W)$. Then, for any $g \in G$,*

$$\Theta_\pi(g) = \sum_{\substack{x \in H\backslash G \\ xgx^{-1} \in H}} \Theta_\rho(xgx^{-1}).$$

Proof. We use the same notation as in the proof of Lemma 4.2. To be more precise, we fix a set of representatives $\{g_1, \dots, g_r\}$ of $H\backslash G$ and a $\mathbb{C}$-basis $\{v_1, \dots, v_n\}$ of W to define a $\mathbb{C}$-basis $\{f_{i,j}\}_{i,j}$ of V. For each $i = 1, \dots, r$, we put

$$V_i := \mathrm{Span}_{\mathbb{C}}\{f_{i,j}\}_j$$

so that

$$V = \bigoplus_{i=1}^{r} V_i.$$

Note that an element $f \in V$ belongs to V_i if and only if $\mathrm{supp}(f) \subset Hg_i$.

Let $g \in G$. Then, for any $f \in V$, we have $\mathrm{supp}(\pi(g)f) = \mathrm{supp}(f)g^{-1}$. Thus, for each i, if we let i' be the unique index such that $Hg_ig^{-1} = Hg_{i'}$, then $\pi(g)$ maps V_i to $V_{i'}$. Hence,

$$\Theta_\pi(g) = \mathrm{Tr}(\pi(g) \mid V) = \sum_{\substack{i=1,\dots,r \\ Hg_ig^{-1}=Hg_i}} \mathrm{Tr}(\pi(g) \mid V_i).$$

Let us compute each summand by fixing i such that $Hg_ig^{-1} = Hg_i$, or equivalently, $g \in g_i^{-1}Hg_i$. For each $j = 1, \dots, n$, we write

$$\pi(g)f_{i,j} = \sum_{l=1}^{n} a_l^{(j)}(g) f_{i,l}$$

with coefficients $a_l^{(j)}(g) \in \mathbb{C}$. With this notation, $\mathrm{Tr}(\pi(g) \mid V_i)$ is given by

$$\mathrm{Tr}(\pi(g) \mid V_i) = \sum_{j=1}^{n} a_j^{(j)}(g).$$

On the other hand, if we write $g = g_i^{-1}hg_i$ with an element $h \in H$, then, by evaluating the identity $\pi(g)f_{i,j} = \sum_{l=1}^{n} a_l^{(j)}(g) f_{i,l}$ at g_i, we get

$$f_{i,j}(hg_i) = \sum_{l=1}^{n} a_l^{(j)}(g) f_{i,l}(g_i),$$

which implies

$$\rho(h)v_j = \sum_{l=1}^{n} a_l^{(j)}(g) v_l.$$

This identity shows that we also have

$$\mathrm{Tr}(\rho(h) \mid W) = \sum_{j=1}^{n} a_j^{(j)}(g).$$

Therefore, in summary, we have obtained

$$\begin{aligned} \Theta_\pi(g) &= \sum_{\substack{i=1,\dots,r \\ Hg_ig^{-1}=Hg_i}} \mathrm{Tr}(\pi(g) \mid V_i) \\ &= \sum_{\substack{x \in H\backslash G \\ xgx^{-1} \in H}} \mathrm{Tr}(\rho(xgx^{-1}) \mid W) = \sum_{\substack{x \in H\backslash G \\ xgx^{-1} \in H}} \Theta_\rho(xgx^{-1}). \end{aligned}$$

This completes the proof. □

Corollary 4.4. *Let G be a finite group and H a normal subgroup. Let (ρ, W) be a finite-dimensional representation of H. We put $(\pi, V) := (\mathrm{Ind}_H^G \rho, \mathrm{Ind}_H^G W)$. Then, for any $g \in G$,*

$$\Theta_\pi(g) = \begin{cases} 0 & \text{if } g \notin H, \\ \sum_{x \in H\backslash G} \Theta_\rho(xgx^{-1}) & \text{if } g \in H. \end{cases}$$

4.3. **Frobenius reciprocity.**

Theorem 4.5. *Let G be a finite group and H its subgroup. Let (π, V) be a finite-dimensional representation of G. Let (ρ, W) be a finite-dimensional representation of H. Then we have*

$$\mathrm{Hom}_G(\pi, \mathrm{Ind}_H^G \rho) \cong \mathrm{Hom}_H(\mathrm{Res}_H^G \pi, \rho).$$

Proof. We construct $\mathbb{C}$-linear maps between two homomorphism sets which are inverses to each other.

We first construct a $\mathbb{C}$-linear map

$$F\colon \mathrm{Hom}_G(\pi, \mathrm{Ind}_H^G \rho) \to \mathrm{Hom}_H(\mathrm{Res}_H^G \pi, \rho).$$

For any $\phi \in \mathrm{Hom}_G(\pi, \mathrm{Ind}_H^G \rho)$, we define a $\mathbb{C}$-linear homomorphism $F(\phi)\colon V \to W$ by

$$F(\phi)(v) := \phi(v)(1)$$

for $v \in V$ (note that $\phi(v)$ is an element of $\mathrm{Ind}_H^G W$, hence a W-valued function on G). Then $F(\phi)$ is also an H-homomorphism. Indeed, using that ϕ is a G-homomorphism, we have

$$F(\phi)(\pi(h)v) = \phi(\pi(h)v)(1) = \big((\mathrm{Ind}_H^G \rho)(h)(\phi(v))\big)(1) = \phi(v)(h).$$

Since $\phi(v)$ is an element of $\mathrm{Ind}_H^G W$, we get

$$\phi(v)(h) = \rho(h)\phi(v)(1) = \rho(h)F(\phi)(v).$$

We next construct a $\mathbb{C}$-linear map

$$F'\colon \mathrm{Hom}_H(\mathrm{Res}_H^G \pi, \rho) \to \mathrm{Hom}_G(\pi, \mathrm{Ind}_H^G \rho).$$

For any $\psi \in \mathrm{Hom}_H(\mathrm{Res}_H^G \pi, \rho)$, we define a $\mathbb{C}$-linear homomorphism $F'(\psi)\colon V \to \mathrm{Ind}_H^G W$ by

$$F'(\psi)(v)(x) := \psi(\pi(x)v)$$

for $v \in V$. Then $F'(\psi)$ is a G-homomorphism. Indeed, we have

$$F'(\psi)(\pi(g)v)(x) = \psi(\pi(x)\pi(g)v) = \psi(\pi(xg)v) = F'(\psi)(v)(xg) = \big((\mathrm{Ind}_H^G \rho)(g)F'(\psi)(v)\big)(x)$$

(recall that the action $\mathrm{Ind}_H^G \rho$ is defined to be the right-translation for W-valued functions).

It is routine to check that these maps are inverses to each other, so let me omit it. □

Remark 4.6. (1) By Corollary 2.16, we may also interpret Theorem 4.5 as the identity

$$(\Theta_\pi, \Theta_{\mathrm{Ind}_H^G \rho})_G = (\Theta_\pi|_H, \Theta_\rho)_H.$$

(2) In the more sophisticated language of category theory, we may understand that Theorem 4.5 says that the functor

$$\mathrm{Res}_H^G\colon \mathrm{Rep}(G) \to \mathrm{Rep}(H)$$

between the categories of finite-dimensional representations of G and H is the "left adjoint" to the functor

$$\mathrm{Ind}_H^G\colon \mathrm{Rep}(H) \to \mathrm{Rep}(G).$$

4.4. **Exercises.**

Exercise 4.1. Let G be a finite group and H a normal subgroup of index 2. Let $\chi\colon H \to \mathbb{C}^\times$ be a character of H (1-dimensional representation). Determine the irreducible decomposition of $\operatorname{Ind}_H^G \chi$.

Exercise 4.2. Let $n \in \mathbb{Z}_{>1}$. Prove that $\operatorname{Ind}_{\mathfrak{S}_{n-1}}^{\mathfrak{S}_n} \mathbb{1}$ decomposes into the direct sum of the trivial representation and an $(n-1)$-dimensional irreducible representation.

5. Lecture 5: Mackey decomposition

5.1. **Restriction problem.** Let G be a finite group and H its subgroup. Recall that, for a representation (π, V) of G, we may consider its restriction $(\mathrm{Res}^G_H \pi, V)$. In fact, it is generally not so easy to understand how representations of G behave under the restriction to H.

For example, even if π is irreducible as a representation of G, its restriction to H may not be irreducible in general. So it is natural to ask when $\mathrm{Res}^G_H \pi$ remains irreducible. If $\mathrm{Res}^G_H \pi$ is reducible, then the next question is how to describe the irreducible decomposition of $\mathrm{Res}^G_H \pi$. Which irreducible representations of H do appear in $\mathrm{Res}^G_H \pi$? What are their multiplicities?

All these problems do heavily depend on the setting, i.e., which groups G and H we consider, and also which kind of representations of G we look at.

In this lecture, we study this *restriction problem* in the case of induced representations.

5.2. **Mackey decomposition.** Let G be a finite group. For two subgroups H and K of G, we consider the following problem:

- Let (ρ, W) be a representation of H.
- Let $(\mathrm{Ind}^G_H \rho, \mathrm{Ind}^G_H W)$ be its induction to G.
- If we restrict it to K, then how $\mathrm{Res}^G_K \mathrm{Ind}^G_H \rho$ can be described?

The *Mackey decomposition* theorem provides a one answer to this problem. To explain it, we introduce several notation.

For $g \in G$, we write $H^g := g^{-1}Hg$. For a representation (ρ, W) of H, we write (ρ^g, W^g) for the representation of H^g on $W^g := W$ defined by

$$\rho^g(g^{-1}hg) := \rho(h)$$

for $h \in H$.

We first fix a complete set of representatives S of the double quotient $H\backslash G/K$. For $s \in S$, we consider the representation (ρ^s, W^s) of H^s defined as above. Moreover, by putting $H_s := H^s \cap K$, we define a representation (ρ_s, W_s) by

$$\rho_s := \mathrm{Res}^{H^s}_{H_s} \rho^s.$$

Theorem 5.1 (Mackey decomposition)**.** *We have a decomposition as representations of K:*

$$\mathrm{Res}^G_K(\mathrm{Ind}^G_H \rho) \cong \bigoplus_{s \in S} \mathrm{Ind}^K_{H_s} \rho_s.$$

Proof. Let us write $(\pi, V) := (\mathrm{Ind}^G_H \rho, \mathrm{Ind}^G_H W)$. Recall that, by definition,

$$V = \mathrm{Ind}^G_H W := \{f \colon G \to W \mid f(hx) = \rho(h)(f(x)) \text{ for any } x \in G, h \in H\}.$$

For each $s \in S$, we define a subspace $V(s)$ of V to be the set of functions $f \colon G \to W$ such that

- $\mathrm{supp}(f) \subset HsK$, and
- $f(hx) = \rho(h)(f(x))$ for any $x \in G, h \in H$.

Then we obviously have a decomposition as a $\mathbb{C}$-vector space

$$V = \bigoplus_{s \in S} V(s).$$

Moreover, since the G-action π on V is defined by the right-translation for functions $G \to W$, we can also see that $V(s)$ is stable under the action of K. In other words, as a representation of K, we have

$$\mathrm{Res}^G_K(\mathrm{Ind}^G_H W) \cong \bigoplus_{s \in S} V(s).$$

Hence it is enough to see that each $V(s)$ is in fact isomorphic to $\mathrm{Ind}^K_{H_s} \rho_s$. We define a homomorphism

$$V(s) \to \mathrm{Ind}^K_{H_s} W_s \colon f \mapsto f_K$$

as representations of K by

$$f_K(k) := f(sk)$$

for $k \in K$. This is well-defined. Indeed, obviously the map $f \mapsto f_K$ preserves the K-actions (right-translation). Moreover, for any $s^{-1}hs = k' \in H_s = s^{-1}Hs \cap K$, we have

$$f_K(k' \cdot k) = f(sk'k) = f(hsk) = \rho(h)f(sk) = \rho^s(s^{-1}hs)f_K(k).$$

In other words, the function $f_K \colon K \to W_s$ belongs to $\mathrm{Ind}^K_{H_s} W_s$.

Conversely, we define a map of opposite direction

$$\mathrm{Ind}^K_{H_s} W_s \to V(s) \colon f_K \mapsto f$$

by the conditions $\mathrm{supp}(f) \subset HsK$ and

$$f(hsk) := \rho(h)f_K(k)$$

for $h \in H$ and $k \in K$. It is straightforward to check that this is well-defined and gives the inverse to the above map. Hence we concluded that $V(s)$ is isomorphic to $\mathrm{Ind}^K_{H_s} W_s$ as representations of K. □

5.3. **Mackey's irreducibility criterion.** Let us consider the special case where $K = H$.

Theorem 5.2. *Let G be a finite group and H a subgroup of G. Let (ρ, W) be an irreducible representation of H. Then its induction $\pi := \mathrm{Ind}^G_H \rho$ is irreducible if and only if the representations ρ_s and $\mathrm{Res}^H_{H_s} \rho$ of H_s have no common irreducible constituent for any $s \in G \smallsetminus H$.*

Proof. Recall that π is irreducible if and only if the self-inner product of its character $(\Theta_\pi, \Theta_\pi)_G$ is equal to 1. By the Frobenius reciprocity, we have

$$(\Theta_\pi, \Theta_\pi)_G = (\Theta_{\mathrm{Ind}^G_H \rho}, \Theta_{\mathrm{Ind}^G_H \rho})_G = (\Theta_{\mathrm{Res}^G_H \mathrm{Ind}^G_H \rho}, \Theta_\rho)_H.$$

On the other hand, by the Mackey decomposition, we have

$$\mathrm{Res}^G_H(\mathrm{Ind}^G_H \rho) \cong \bigoplus_{s \in H\backslash G/H} \mathrm{Ind}^H_{H_s} \rho_s.$$

In particular, this implies that, as a function on H, we have

$$\Theta_{\mathrm{Res}^G_H \mathrm{Ind}^G_H \rho} = \sum_{s \in H\backslash G/H} \Theta_{\mathrm{Ind}^H_{H_s} \rho_s}.$$

Hence we get

$$(\Theta_{\mathrm{Res}^G_H \mathrm{Ind}^G_H \rho}, \Theta_\rho)_H = \sum_{s \in H\backslash G/H} (\Theta_{\mathrm{Ind}^H_{H_s} \rho_s}, \Theta_\rho)_H.$$

Again using the Frobenius reciprocity, we furthermore get

$$\sum_{s\in H\backslash G/H}(\Theta_{\mathrm{Ind}_{H_s}^H \rho_s},\Theta_\rho)_H=\sum_{s\in H\backslash G/H}(\Theta_{\rho_s},\Theta_\rho)_{H_s}.$$

When s represents the trivial coset H, we may choose s to be 1. In this case, we simply have $H_s = H^s \cap H = H$ and $\rho_s = \rho$. Thus we get $(\Theta_{\rho_s},\Theta_\rho)_{H_s} = 1$. Therefore, in summary, $(\Theta_\pi,\Theta_\pi)_G = 1$ if and only if we have $(\Theta_{\rho_s},\Theta_\rho)_{H_s} = 0$ for any nontrivial coset representatives $s \in S$. The condition that $(\Theta_{\rho_s},\Theta_\rho)_{H_s} = 0$ is equivalent to the condition that ρ_s and $\mathrm{Res}^H_{H_s}\rho$ do not have the same irreducible constituent. □

Let us think about some particular cases which would be convenient.

Corollary 5.3. *Let G be a finite group and H a normal subgroup of G. Let (ρ, W) be an irreducible representation of H. Then its induction $\pi := \mathrm{Ind}_H^G \rho$ is irreducible if and only if the representations ρ_s and ρ of H_s are not isomorphic for any $s \in G \smallsetminus H$.*

Proof. Since H is normal in G, we have

$$H_s := s^{-1}Hs \cap H = H$$

for any $s \in G$. Moreover, since ρ is irreducible, the representations ρ_s and ρ of H have no common irreducible constituent if and only if they are not isomorphic. Hence the corollary is just a special case of the Mackey criterion. □

Corollary 5.4. *Let G be a finite group and H a subgroup of G. Let $(\rho, \mathbb{C})$ be a 1-dimensional irreducible representation of H. Then its induction $\pi := \mathrm{Ind}_H^G \rho$ is irreducible if and only if the representations ρ_s and $\mathrm{Res}^H_{H_s}\rho$ of H_s are not isomorphic for any $s \in G \smallsetminus H$.*

Proof. The representations ρ_s and $\mathrm{Res}^H_{H_s}\rho$ of H_s are both 1-dimensional. Therefore, they have no common irreducible constituent if and only if they are not isomorphic. Hence the corollary is just a special case of the Mackey criterion. □

5.4. **Example: Heisenberg groups.** As an application of the results we have learned so far, let us study representation theory of finite Heisenberg groups.

Before we introduce a Heisenberg group, let us define the notion of central character:

Lemma 5.5. *Let G be a finite group with center Z. Then, for any irreducible representation (π, V) of G, there exists a character $\chi\colon Z \to \mathbb{C}^\times$ such that*

$$\pi(z)v = \chi(z)v$$

for any $z \in Z$ and $v \in V$ (or, equivalently, $\mathrm{Res}^G_Z \pi \cong \chi^{\oplus \dim V}$).

Proof. Let $z \in Z$. Then we have $\pi(g)\pi(z) = \pi(gz) = \pi(zg) = \pi(z)\pi(g)$ for any $g \in G$. This means that $\pi(g) \in \mathrm{End}_{\mathbb{C}}(V)$ is in fact a G-homomorphism, i.e., $\pi(g) \in \mathrm{End}_G(V)$. By Schur's lemma, we know that $\mathrm{End}_G(V) = \mathbb{C} \cdot \mathrm{id}_V$. Hence there exists an element $\chi(z) \in \mathbb{C}^\times$ such that $\pi(z) = \chi(z) \cdot \mathrm{id}_V$. It can be easily checked that the association $z \mapsto \chi(z)$ is a homomorphism from Z to $\mathbb{C}^\times$. □

Definition 5.6. For any irreducible representation (π, V) of a finite group G, the character of the center of G associated to (π, V) as in the above lemma is called the *central character* of (π, V).

Let $\mathbb{F}_q$ be a finite field of characteristic $p > 0$. We assume that p is odd.

We consider a finite-dimensional $\mathbb{F}_q$-vector space $\mathbb{V}$ equipped with a symplectic form $\omega\colon \mathbb{V} \times \mathbb{V} \to \mathbb{F}_q$, that is, ω is a non-degenerate alternating bilinear form on $\mathbb{V}$. Note that, $\dim \mathbb{V}$ must be even (say $2n$) so that such ω exists.

We consider the product set $\mathbb{H} := \mathbb{V} \times \mathbb{F}_q$. For any $(v_1, z_1), (v_2, z_2) \in \mathbb{H}$, we put

$$(v_1, z_1) \cdot (v_2, z_2) := \left(v_1 + v_2, z_1 + z_2 + \frac{1}{2}\omega(v_1, v_2)\right) \in \mathbb{H}.$$

Then we can easily check that $\mathbb{H}$ forms a group with respect to this operation. We call this group $\mathbb{H}$ the *Heisenberg group* associated to the symplectic space $(\mathbb{V}, \omega)$. The following can be also easily checked:

(1) The order of $\mathbb{H}$ is q^{2n+1}.
(2) The center $Z(\mathbb{H})$ of $\mathbb{H}$ is $\{0\} \times \mathbb{F}_q$.
(3) The commutator subgroup $[\mathbb{H}, \mathbb{H}]$ is equal to $Z(\mathbb{H})$.
(4) The quotient $\mathbb{H}/Z(\mathbb{H})$ is isomorphic to $\mathbb{V}$.

Remark 5.7. It is well-known that any symplectic forms on the same $\mathbb{F}_q$-vector space are equivalent to each other. Hence, by choosing a suitable $\mathbb{F}_q$-basis of $\mathbb{V}$, you may assume that the representation matrix of ω is of a form you prefer: for example,

$$\begin{pmatrix} 0 & I_n \\ -I_n & 0 \end{pmatrix}, \quad \begin{pmatrix} & & & 1 \\ & & -1 & \\ & \iddots & & \\ -1 & & & \end{pmatrix}, \quad \text{and so on.}$$

Let us try to classify all irreducible representations of $\mathbb{H}$.

We first consider characters (1-dimensional representations) of $\mathbb{H}$. Any 1-dimensional representation can be thought of as a homomorphism $\mathbb{H} \to \mathrm{GL}_1(\mathbb{C}) = \mathbb{C}^\times$, hence must factor through the maximal abelian quotient of $\mathbb{H}$, i.e., $\mathbb{H}/[\mathbb{H}, \mathbb{H}]$. Since $\mathbb{H}/Z(\mathbb{H}) \cong \mathbb{V}$, such a homomorphism is identified with a character of $\mathbb{V}$. Conversely, any character of $\mathbb{V}$ can be regarded as a character of $\mathbb{H}$. Since $\mathbb{V}$ is of order q^{2n}, we conclude that there are q^{2n} characters of $\mathbb{H}$ in total.

Next we consider higher-dimensional irreducible representations.

Theorem 5.8 (Stone–von Neumann's theorem)**.** *For any nontrivial character $\psi\colon \mathbb{F}_q \to \mathbb{C}^\times$, there uniquely (up to isomorphism) exists an irreducible representation π_ψ of $\mathbb{H}$ with central character ψ. Moreover, its dimension is given by q^n.*

Proof. We fix a polarization $\mathbb{V} = \mathbb{V}_1 \oplus \mathbb{V}_2$. Here, a "polarization" means that both $\mathbb{V}_1$ and $\mathbb{V}_2$ are Lagrangian subspaces (maximal totally isotropic subspaces) of the symplectic space $\mathbb{V}$ in the sense that $\mathbb{V}_i$ is a maximal subspace satisfying $\omega|_{\mathbb{V}_i \times \mathbb{V}_i} = 0$ for $i = 1, 2$. For example, if we choose an $\mathbb{F}_q$-basis $v_1, \dots, v_{2n}$ of $\mathbb{V}$ so that the representation matrix of ω is $\left(\begin{smallmatrix} 0 & I_n \\ -I_n & 0 \end{smallmatrix}\right)$, then we may choose $\mathbb{V}_1$ and $\mathbb{V}_2$ to be the subspaces spanned by $\{v_1, \dots, v_n\}$ and $\{v_{n+1}, \dots, v_{2n}\}$, respectively.

We put $\mathbb{H}' := \mathbb{V}_1 \times \mathbb{F}_q \subset \mathbb{H}$. Let us show that this is a normal subgroup of $\mathbb{H}$. Since $\mathbb{H}$ is generated by $\mathbb{V}_1 \times \{0\}$, $\mathbb{V}_2 \times \{0\}$, and $Z(\mathbb{H}) = \{0\} \times \mathbb{F}_q$, it is enough to check that $\mathbb{H}'$ is closed under the conjugation by these subgroups. It is obvious that $\mathbb{H}'$ is closed under $Z(\mathbb{H})$-conjugation, so let us consider $\mathbb{V}_i \times \{0\}$-conjugation. For any $(v, 0) \in \mathbb{V}_i \times \{0\}$, its inverse is given by $(-v, 0)$ since $\mathbb{V}_i$ is a Lagrangian

subspace.[2] Hence, for any $(v', z) \in \mathbb{H}' = \mathbb{V}_1 \times \mathbb{F}_q$, we have

$$\begin{aligned}(v,0)\cdot(v',z)\cdot(v,0)^{-1} &= (v,0)\cdot(v',z)\cdot(-v,0)\\ &= (v,0)\cdot\Big(v'-v, z+\frac{1}{2}\omega(v',-v)\Big)\\ &= \Big(v', z+\frac{1}{2}\omega(v',-v)+\frac{1}{2}\omega(v,v'-v)\Big)\\ &= \Big(v', z+\omega(v,v')\Big) \in \mathbb{H}'.\end{aligned}$$

We note that the subgroup $\mathbb{H}'$ is abelian since $\mathbb{V}_1$ is a Lagrangian subspace. In particular, for any nontrivial character $\psi\colon \mathbb{F}_q \to \mathbb{C}^\times$, we may find its extension $\tilde{\psi}\colon \mathbb{H}' \to \mathbb{C}^\times$ (this is a consequence of the classification theorem of finite abelian groups). We fix any such $\tilde{\psi}$ and put

$$\pi_{\tilde{\psi}} := \mathrm{Ind}_{\mathbb{H}'}^{\mathbb{H}} \tilde{\psi}.$$

We claim that $\pi_{\tilde{\psi}}$ is an irreducible representation of $\mathbb{H}$ with central character ψ. It is obvious that the central character is ψ. To show the irreducibility, by Corollary 5.3, it is enough to verify that $\tilde{\psi}^s \neq \tilde{\psi}$ for any $s \in \mathbb{H} \smallsetminus \mathbb{H}'$. Let us write $s = (v_1 + v_2, z)$, where $v_i \in \mathbb{V}_i$, $z \in \mathbb{F}_q$ such that $v_2 \neq 0$. As we have $\tilde{\psi}^s = \tilde{\psi}^{(v_2,0)}$, it suffices to check that $\tilde{\psi}^{(v_2,0)} \neq \tilde{\psi}$. For any $(v', z') \in \mathbb{H}' = \mathbb{V}_1 \times \mathbb{F}_q$, we have

$$\begin{aligned}\tilde{\psi}^{(v_2,0)}((v',z')) &= \tilde{\psi}\big((v_2,0)\cdot(v',z')\cdot(v_2,0)^{-1}\big)\\ &= \tilde{\psi}\big((v', z'+\omega(v_2,v'))\big)\\ &= \tilde{\psi}\big((v',z')\big)\cdot\psi(\omega(v_2,v')).\end{aligned}$$

(see the previous computation). As $\mathbb{V} = \mathbb{V}_1 \oplus \mathbb{V}_2$ is a polarization, the map $\mathbb{V}_1 \to \mathbb{F}_q\colon v' \to \omega(v_2, v')$ is surjective. Thus, recalling that ψ is a nontrivial character of $\mathbb{F}_q$, we see that there exists $v' \in \mathbb{V}_1$ such that $\psi(\omega(v_2, v')) \neq 1$. In particular, we see that $\tilde{\psi}^{(v_2,0)} \neq \tilde{\psi}$ as a character of $\mathbb{H}'$.

Now, we have obtained an irreducible representation $\pi_{\tilde{\psi}}$ with central character ψ for each nontrivial character $\psi\colon \mathbb{F}_q \to \mathbb{C}^\times$. Let us do a counting argument. By the dimension formula for induced representation, we have $\dim \pi_{\tilde{\psi}} = [\mathbb{H} : \mathbb{H}'] = q^n$. By the square-sum formula for dimensions of irreducible representations, we have

$$\sum_{\pi \in \mathrm{Irr}(\mathbb{H})} (\dim \pi)^2 = |\mathbb{H}| = q^{2n+1}.$$

So far, at least, we have constructed

- q^{2n} many 1-dimensional irreducible representations, and
- $(q-1)$ many q^n-dimensional irreducible representations ($q-1$ is the number of nontrivial characters of $\mathbb{F}_q$).

However, we have

$$q^{2n}\cdot 1^2 + (q-1)\cdot(q^n)^2 = q^{2n+1}.$$

In other words, the square sum of the irreducible representations we have constructed already reaches $|\mathbb{H}|$. This means that there are no more irreducible representations of $\mathbb{H}$. In particular, we conclude that $\pi_{\tilde{\psi}}$ is the unique irreducible

[2] This observation is actually not essential here; the subgroup $\mathbb{H}'$ is a normal subgroup even if $\mathbb{V}_1$ is replaced with any subspace of $\mathbb{V}$.

representation of $\mathbb{H}$ with central character ψ (hence $\pi_{\tilde{\psi}}$ is actually independent of the choice of $\tilde{\psi}$). $\square$

5.5. **Exercises.**

Exercise 5.1. Let $G := \mathrm{GL}_2(\mathbb{F}_q)$. We consider the subgroup B of G consisting of upper-triangular matrices, i.e.,

$$B := \left\{ \begin{pmatrix} a & b \\ 0 & d \end{pmatrix} \,\middle|\, a, d \in \mathbb{F}_q^\times,\, b \in \mathbb{F}_q \right\} \subset \mathrm{GL}_2(\mathbb{F}_q)$$

For characters (1-dimensional representations) $\chi_1 \colon \mathbb{F}_q^\times \to \mathbb{C}^\times$ and $\chi_2 \colon \mathbb{F}_q^\times \to \mathbb{C}^\times$ of $\mathbb{F}_q^\times$, we consider the following character of B:

$$\chi \colon B \to \mathbb{C}^\times; \quad \begin{pmatrix} a & b \\ 0 & d \end{pmatrix} \mapsto \chi_1(a) \cdot \chi_2(d).$$

Describe the irreducible decomposition of $\mathrm{Ind}_B^G \chi$.

Exercise 5.2. Let $G := \mathrm{GL}_2(\mathbb{F}_q)$. We consider the following subgroups of G:

$$M := \left\{ \begin{pmatrix} a & b \\ 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix} \,\middle|\, a \in \mathbb{F}_q^\times,\, b \in \mathbb{F}_q \right\} \subset \mathrm{GL}_2(\mathbb{F}_q),$$

$$N := \left\{ \begin{pmatrix} 1 & b \\ 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix} \,\middle|\, b \in \mathbb{F}_q \right\} \subset M,$$

For a nontrivial character $\psi \colon N \cong \mathbb{F}_q \to \mathbb{C}^\times$, we put

$$\Pi_\psi = \mathrm{Ind}_N^M \psi.$$

(1) Show that Π_ψ is irreducible.
(2) Classify all irreducible representations of M.

Exercise 5.3. Let $\mathbb{H}$ be the Heisenberg group associated to a $2n$-dimensional symplectic space $(\mathbb{V}, \omega)$ over $\mathbb{F}_q$ (of odd characteristic). We fix a nontrivial character $\psi \colon \mathbb{F}_q \to \mathbb{C}^\times$ and consider an irreducible representation π_ψ with central character ψ, which uniquely exists by the Stone–von Neumann theorem.

(1) Compute the character $\Theta_{\pi_\psi}(v, z)$ for any $(v, z) \in \mathbb{H}$.
(2) Determine the irreducible decomposition of the representation $\pi_\psi \otimes \pi_\psi^\vee$.

Exercise 5.4. Let G be a nontrivial p-group, i.e., a finite group whose order is a power of a prime number p. Suppose that there exists an irreducible representation (π, V) of G which is *faithful*, that is, $\pi \colon G \to \mathrm{Aut}_{\mathbb{C}}(V)$ is injective. Prove that the center Z of G is a nontrivial cyclic group.

6. Lecture 6: Brauer's induction theorem

6.1. **More about induced representations.** Here we list a few more important properties of the induction.

Proposition 6.1 (chain rule)**.** *Let G be a finite group and $H' \subset H$ be subgroups of G. For any representation (σ, W) of H',*

$$\mathrm{Ind}_H^G(\mathrm{Ind}_{H'}^H \sigma) \cong \mathrm{Ind}_{H'}^G \sigma.$$

Proof. To show the assertion, it is enough to show that the Hom spaces

$$\mathrm{Hom}_G\big(\pi, \mathrm{Ind}_H^G(\mathrm{Ind}_{H'}^H \sigma)\big)$$

and

$$\mathrm{Hom}_G(\pi, \mathrm{Ind}_{H'}^G \sigma)$$

are isomorphic for any representation π of G. By using Frobenius reciprocity twice, we get

$$\begin{aligned}\mathrm{Hom}_G\big(\pi, \mathrm{Ind}_H^G(\mathrm{Ind}_{H'}^H \sigma)\big) &\cong \mathrm{Hom}_H(\mathrm{Res}_H^G \pi, \mathrm{Ind}_{H'}^H \sigma)\\ &\cong \mathrm{Hom}_{H'}\big(\mathrm{Res}_{H'}^H(\mathrm{Res}_H^G \pi), \sigma\big).\end{aligned}$$

Obviously we have $\mathrm{Res}_{H'}^H(\mathrm{Res}_H^G(-)) = \mathrm{Res}_{H'}^G(-)$. Hence, again by using the Frobenius reciprocity, we get

$$\begin{aligned}\mathrm{Hom}_{H'}\big(\mathrm{Res}_{H'}^H(\mathrm{Res}_H^G \pi), \sigma\big) &\cong \mathrm{Hom}_{H'}(\mathrm{Res}_{H'}^G \pi, \sigma)\\ &\cong \mathrm{Hom}_G(\pi, \mathrm{Ind}_{H'}^G \sigma).\end{aligned}$$

This completes the proof. □

Proposition 6.2 (projection formula)**.** *Let G be a finite group and $H \subset G$ a subgroup. For any representation σ of H and any representation π of G,*

$$\mathrm{Ind}_H^G\big(\sigma \otimes (\mathrm{Res}_H^G \pi)\big) \cong (\mathrm{Ind}_H^G \sigma) \otimes \pi.$$

Proof. Similarly to the proof above, it is enough to show that the Hom spaces

$$\mathrm{Hom}_G\Big(\pi', \mathrm{Ind}_H^G\big(\sigma \otimes (\mathrm{Res}_H^G \pi)\big)\Big)$$

and

$$\mathrm{Hom}_G\big(\pi', (\mathrm{Ind}_H^G \sigma) \otimes \pi\big)$$

are isomorphic for any representation π' of G. By Frobenius reciprocity,

$$\mathrm{Hom}_G\Big(\pi', \mathrm{Ind}_H^G\big(\sigma \otimes (\mathrm{Res}_H^G \pi)\big)\Big) \cong \mathrm{Hom}_H\big(\mathrm{Res}_H^G \pi', \sigma \otimes (\mathrm{Res}_H^G \pi)\big).$$

By the adjunction between Hom and $\otimes$, we have

$$\mathrm{Hom}_H\big(\mathrm{Res}_H^G \pi', \sigma \otimes (\mathrm{Res}_H^G \pi)\big) \cong \mathrm{Hom}_H\big(\mathrm{Res}_H^G \pi' \otimes (\mathrm{Res}_H^G \pi)^\vee, \sigma\big)$$

(this adjunction has not been explained in this course, but can be proved in a similar manner to the case of $\mathbb{C}$-vector space homomorphisms). Thus, again using Frobenius reciprocity, we get

$$\begin{aligned}\mathrm{Hom}_H\big(\mathrm{Res}_H^G \pi' \otimes (\mathrm{Res}_H^G \pi)^\vee, \sigma\big) &= \mathrm{Hom}_H\big(\mathrm{Res}_H^G(\pi' \otimes \pi^\vee), \sigma\big)\\ &\cong \mathrm{Hom}_G(\pi' \otimes \pi^\vee, \mathrm{Ind}_H^G \sigma).\end{aligned}$$

Again using the Hom-$\otimes$ adjunction, we get

$$\mathrm{Hom}_G(\pi' \otimes \pi^\vee, \mathrm{Ind}_H^G \sigma) \cong \mathrm{Hom}_G\big(\pi', (\mathrm{Ind}_H^G \sigma) \otimes \pi\big).$$

This completes the proof. □

6.2. **Virtual representations.**

Definition 6.3. Let $\mathrm{Irr}(G)$ denote the set of isomorphism classes of irreducible representations of G. Let $\mathbb{Z}[\mathrm{Irr}(G)]$ denote the free abelian group generated by $\mathrm{Irr}(G)$, i.e,

$$\mathbb{Z}[\mathrm{Irr}(G)] := \left\{ \sum_{\pi \in \mathrm{Irr}(G)} n_\pi \pi \;\middle|\; n_\pi \in \mathbb{Z} \text{ for each } \pi \in \mathrm{Irr}(G) \right\}.$$

We call an element of $\mathbb{Z}[\mathrm{Irr}(G)]$ a *virtual representation* of G. For any $\mathbb{Z}$-algebra R, we write $R[\mathrm{Irr}(G)] := \mathbb{Z}[\mathrm{Irr}(G)] \otimes_{\mathbb{Z}} R$.

Remark 6.4. (1) Let $\mathrm{Rep}(G)$ denote the set of isomorphism classes of representations of G. By the semisimplicity of representations of a finite group, $\mathrm{Rep}(G)$ is identified with the subset of $\mathbb{Z}[\mathrm{Irr}(G)]$ consisting of elements with non-negative coefficients:

$$\mathrm{Rep}(G) = \left\{ \sum_{\pi \in \mathrm{Irr}(G)} n_\pi \pi \in \mathbb{Z}[\mathrm{Irr}(G)] \;\middle|\; n_\pi \in \mathbb{Z}_{\geq 0} \text{ for each } \pi \in \mathrm{Irr}(G) \right\}.$$

Using this isomorphism, we often loosely identify a virtual representation of G with its trace character.

(2) Recall that $C(G)$ denotes the set of class functions on G. Also recall that the characters of irreducible representations of G form an orthonormal basis of $C(G)$. This means that taking the character of a representation $[\pi \mapsto \Theta_\pi]$ induces an isomorphism of $\mathbb{C}$-vector spaces

$$\mathbb{C}[\mathrm{Irr}(G)] \xrightarrow{\cong} C(G) \colon \sum_{\pi \in \mathrm{Irr}(G)} c_\pi \pi \mapsto \sum_{\pi \in \mathrm{Irr}(G)} c_\pi \Theta_\pi.$$

(3) The abelian group $\mathbb{Z}[\mathrm{Irr}(G)]$ has a natural ring structure whose multiplication is given by the tensor product of representations. (The unit is the trivial representation.) Recall that $\Theta_{\pi_1 \otimes \pi_2} = \Theta_{\pi_1} \cdot \Theta_{\pi_2}$ (see Exercise 2.1); this implies that the above isomorphism is a $\mathbb{C}$-algebra isomorphism.

(4) Be careful that the image of $\mathbb{Z}[\mathrm{Irr}(G)]$ under the above isomorphism (i.e., the $\mathbb{Z}$-submodule generated by Θ_π for $\pi \in \mathrm{Irr}(G)$) is **not** necessarily equal to the set of $\mathbb{Z}$-valued class functions on G. For example, when $G = \mathbb{Z}/d\mathbb{Z}$, an irreducible representation of G is given by a character $\chi \colon G \to \mathbb{C}^\times$ such that $\chi(1)$ is a d-th root of unity.

Definition 6.5. A representation of G is called *monomial* if it is of the form $\mathrm{Ind}_H^G \chi$ for some subgroup $H \subset G$ and a character (1-dimensional representation) χ of H.

Our goal is the following:

Theorem 6.6 (Brauer's induction theorem)**.** *The abelian group $\mathbb{Z}[\mathrm{Irr}(G)]$ is generated by monomial representations of G. In particular (or, "equivalently"), for any irreducible representation π of G, there exist subgroups $H_1, \ldots, H_r$ of G and characters χ_i of H_i such that*

$$\pi = \sum_{i=1}^{r} n_i \, \mathrm{Ind}_{H_i}^G \chi_i \in \mathbb{Z}[\mathrm{Irr}(G)].$$

6.3. **Artin's theorem.** Let G be a finite group and $H \subset G$ a subgroup. Then the induction $\mathrm{Ind}_H^G(-)$ induces a $\mathbb{Z}$-linear homomorphism

$$\mathrm{Ind}_H^G \colon \mathbb{Z}[\mathrm{Irr}(H)] \to \mathbb{Z}[\mathrm{Irr}(G)]; \quad \sum_{\pi \in \mathrm{Irr}(H)} n_\pi \pi \mapsto \sum_{\pi \in \mathrm{Irr}(H)} n_\pi \, \mathrm{Ind}_H^G \pi.$$

For any set $\mathcal{X}$ of subgroups of G, we define a $\mathbb{Z}$-linear homomorphism $\mathrm{Ind}_{\mathcal{X}}^G$ by taking the sum of Ind_H^G for all $H \in \mathcal{X}$:

$$\mathrm{Ind}_{\mathcal{X}}^G := \bigoplus_{H \in \mathcal{X}} \mathrm{Ind}_H^G \colon \bigoplus_{H \in \mathcal{X}} \mathbb{Z}[\mathrm{Irr}(H)] \to \mathbb{Z}[\mathrm{Irr}(G)].$$

Theorem 6.7 (Artin's theorem)**.** *The following are equivalent:*

(1) $G = \bigcup_{H \in \mathcal{X}} \bigcup_{g \in G} gHg^{-1}$.
(2) $\mathrm{Cok}(\mathrm{Ind}_{\mathcal{X}}^G)$ *is finite.*

Proof. The condition (2) is equivalent to the condition that the map

$$\mathrm{Ind}_{\mathcal{X},\mathbb{Q}}^G := \mathrm{Ind}_{\mathcal{X}}^G \otimes_{\mathbb{Z}} \mathbb{Q} \colon \bigoplus_{H \in \mathcal{X}} \mathbb{Q}[\mathrm{Irr}(H)] \to \mathbb{Q}[\mathrm{Irr}(G)]$$

is surjective, which is further equivalent to the condition that the map

$$\mathrm{Ind}_{\mathcal{X},\mathbb{C}}^G := \mathrm{Ind}_{\mathcal{X}}^G \otimes_{\mathbb{Z}} \mathbb{C} \colon \bigoplus_{H \in \mathcal{X}} C(H) \to C(G)$$

is surjective. We consider the dual map of this map with respect to the inner products on $C(G)$ and $C(H)$ for $H \in \mathcal{X}$:

$$(\mathrm{Ind}_{\mathcal{X},\mathbb{C}}^G)^\vee \colon C(G) \to \bigoplus_{H \in \mathcal{X}} C(H).$$

More precisely, this map is characterized by the property that

$$((\mathrm{Ind}_{\mathcal{X},\mathbb{C}}^G)^\vee(f), f_H)_H = (f, \mathrm{Ind}_{H,\mathbb{C}}^G(f_H))_G$$

for any $f \in C(G)$ and any $f_H \in C(H)$. However, by Frobenius reciprocity, we have

$$(f, \mathrm{Ind}_{H,\mathbb{C}}^G(f_H))_G = (\mathrm{Res}_{H,\mathbb{C}}^G(f), f_H)_H,$$

where $\mathrm{Res}_{H,\mathbb{C}}^G(-)$ denotes the restriction map $C(G) \to C(H)$. Hence, we conclude that $(\mathrm{Ind}_{\mathcal{X},\mathbb{C}}^G)^\vee$ is nothing but the direct sum of the restriction maps:

$$(\mathrm{Ind}_{\mathcal{X},\mathbb{C}}^G)^\vee = \mathrm{Res}_{\mathcal{X},\mathbb{C}}^G := \bigoplus_{H \in \mathcal{X}} \mathrm{Res}_{H,\mathbb{C}}^G \colon C(G) \to \bigoplus_{H \in \mathcal{X}} C(H).$$

Therefore, we see that the surjectivity of $\mathrm{Ind}_{\mathcal{X},\mathbb{C}}^G$ is equivalent to the injectivity of $\mathrm{Res}_{\mathcal{X},\mathbb{C}}^G$.

Now our task is to check that the injectivity of $\mathrm{Res}_{\mathcal{X},\mathbb{C}}^G$ is equivalent to the condition (1). Suppose that $f \in C(G)$. Then f belongs to $\mathrm{Ker}(\mathrm{Res}_{\mathcal{X},\mathbb{C}}^G)$ if and only if $f|_H = 0$ for any $H \in \mathcal{X}$. Since f is a class function, this is equivalent to the condition that $f|_{gHg^{-1}} = 0$ for any $H \in \mathcal{X}$ and any $g \in G$. Therefore, if (1) holds, then such f must be 0. Conversely, if (1) does not hold, then there exists $g \in G$ which is not contained in any conjugate of any $H \in \mathcal{X}$. Then the characteristic function $\mathbb{1}_{C_g}$ of the conjugacy class C_g of g is a nonzero element of $\mathrm{Ker}(\mathrm{Res}_{\mathcal{X},\mathbb{C}}^G)$. $\square$

6.4. **Reduction to "pre-Brauer".** In the following, the symbol p always denotes a prime number.

Definition 6.8. (1) A finite group is called *p-elementary* if it is of the form $C \times P$, where C is a cyclic group of order prime-to-p and P is a p-group (i.e., a group of order a power of p).

(2) A finite group is called *elementary* if it is p-elementary for some prime number p.

For a fixed finite group G, we let

- $\mathcal{E}_p$ denote the set of p-elementary subgroups of G, and
- $\mathcal{E}$ denote the set of elementary subgroups of G.

Note that any $g \in G$ is contained in the cyclic subgroup $\langle g \rangle \subset G$ generated by g, which is of course a p-elementary group for any prime number p. Hence, $\mathcal{E}_p$ satisfies the condition (1) in Artin's theorem (Theorem 6.7). Let us write V_p the image of $\mathrm{Ind}_{\mathcal{E}_p}^G$ in $\mathbb{Z}[\mathrm{Irr}(G)]$, which is of finite index by Artin's theorem:

$$V_p := \mathrm{Im}\Big(\mathrm{Ind}_{\mathcal{E}_p}^G : \bigoplus_{H \in \mathcal{E}_p} \mathbb{Z}[\mathrm{Irr}(H)] \to \mathbb{Z}[\mathrm{Irr}(G)]\Big) \subset \mathbb{Z}[\mathrm{Irr}(G)].$$

Furthermore, note that V_p is an ideal of the ring $\mathbb{Z}[\mathrm{Irr}(G)]$; this is a consequence of the projection formula (Proposition 6.2).

The key step in the proof of Brauer's induction theorem is to prove the following theorem. For our convenience, let us call this theorem the "pre-Brauer" theorem.

Theorem 6.9 ("pre-Brauer")**.** *The index $[\mathbb{Z}[\mathrm{Irr}(G)] : V_p]$ is finite. More precisely, if we write $|G| = p^r \cdot m$ with $r \in \mathbb{Z}_{\geq 0}$ and $m \in \mathbb{Z}_{>0}$ prime-to-p, then the index $[\mathbb{Z}[\mathrm{Irr}(G)] : V_p]$ divides a power of m.*

Before we prove the pre-Brauer theorem, let us see how the Brauer induction theorem follows from it.

Theorem 6.9 $\implies$ Theorem 6.6. We consider the finite-index subgroup $V_p \subset \mathbb{Z}[\mathrm{Irr}(G)]$ for each prime number p. By Theorem 6.9, the index $[\mathbb{Z}[\mathrm{Irr}(G)] : V_p]$ is prime-to-p. We let V be the submodule of $\mathbb{Z}[\mathrm{Irr}(G)]$ generated by V_p for all prime numbers p. Since $V_p \subset V$, the index $[\mathbb{Z}[\mathrm{Irr}(G)] : V]$ must divide $[\mathbb{Z}[\mathrm{Irr}(G)] : V_p]$. Hence $[\mathbb{Z}[\mathrm{Irr}(G)] : V]$ is prime-to-p for any prime number p, which implies $[\mathbb{Z}[\mathrm{Irr}(G)] : V] = 1$. In other words, any virtual representation of G can be written as a $\mathbb{Z}$-linear combination of induced representations from characters of elementary subgroups.

Here, we appeal to a nontrivial fact that any irreducible representation of an elementary group is monomial (see [Ser77, Chapter 8]; this is a consequence of a fact that any irreducible represenation of a p-group is monomial). If we write a virtual representation of G as

$$\sum_{i=1}^{r} n_i \,\mathrm{Ind}_{H_i}^G \pi_i,$$

where $n_i \in \mathbb{Z}$, $H_i \in \mathcal{E}$, and $\pi_i \in \mathrm{Irr}(H_i)$ then we can write each π_i as $\mathrm{Ind}_{H_i'}^{H_i} \chi_i$ with a subgroup $H_i' \subset H_i$ and a 1-dimensional representation χ_i of H_i', hence we get

$$\sum_{i=1}^{r} n_i \,\mathrm{Ind}_{H_i}^G \pi_i = \sum_{i=1}^{r} n_i \,\mathrm{Ind}_{H_i}^G (\mathrm{Ind}_{H_i'}^{H_i} \chi_i) = \sum_{i=1}^{r} n_i \,\mathrm{Ind}_{H_i'}^G \chi_i$$

by the chain rule of the induction. □

6.5. **Proof of "pre-Brauer".** We first introduce several supplementary notions.

Definition 6.10. Let G be a finite group. Let $g \in G$

- We call g a *p'-element* if the order of g is prime-to-p.
- We call g a *p-element* if the order of g is p-power.

Lemma 6.11. *Any $g \in G$ can be uniquely written as $g = su$, where s is a p'-element and u is a p-element such that $su = us$.*

Proof. Let $d = p^r \cdot m$ be the order of g, where $r \in \mathbb{Z}_{\geq 0}$ and $m \in \mathbb{Z}_{>0}$ is a prime-to-p number. Then g^{p^r} is a p'-element and g^m is a p-element. Since p^r and m are coprime, we can find integers a and b such that $ap^r + bm \equiv 1 \pmod{d}$, which implies that

$$g = g^{ap^r+bm} = (g^{p^r})^a \cdot (g^m)^b.$$

Thus, if we put $s := (g^{p^r})^a$ and $u := (g^m)^b$, then s and u satisfy the desired conditions.

To check the uniqueness, suppose that we have another such pair (s', u'). By taking the p^r-th power of $su = s'u'$, we get $s^{p^r} = s'^{p^r}$. Since s and s' are p'-element, this implies that $s = s'$, hence also $u = u'$. □

We call the decomposition $g = su$ as in this lemma the *p-Jordan decomposition* of $g \in G$.

For any positive integer $d \in \mathbb{Z}_{>0}$, we let $\mu_d \subset \mathbb{C}$ denote the set of $d-$th roots of unity. We write $\mathbb{Z}[\mu_d] \subset \mathbb{C}$ for the $\mathbb{Z}$-subalgebra of $\mathbb{C}$ generated by μ_d (this is a finitely generated free $\mathbb{Z}$-module).

Proposition 6.12. *Let G be a finite group of order d. Let $s \in G$ be a p'-element. Then there exists an element $\psi_s \in V_p \otimes_{\mathbb{Z}} \mathbb{Z}[\mu_d]$ such that*

1. *ψ_s is integer-valued,*
2. *$\psi_s(s) \not\equiv 0 \pmod{p}$, and*
3. *$\psi_s(s') = 0$ for any p'-element of G which is not conjugate to s.*

Proof. We let m be the order of s. We put $C := \langle s \rangle$. Let $\psi_C \colon C \to \mathbb{Z}$ be the function defined by

$$\psi_C(c) = \begin{cases} m & c = s, \\ 0 & c \neq s. \end{cases}$$

Then we can easily check that

$$\psi_C = \sum_{\chi \in \mathrm{Irr}(C)} \chi(s)^{-1} \cdot \chi.$$

As each $\chi(s)^{-1}$ belongs to $\mathbb{Z}[\mu_d]$, this implies that $\psi_C \in \mathbb{Z}[\mu_d][\mathrm{Irr}(C)]$.

We fix a p-Sylow subgroup P of the centralizer group $Z_G(s)$ of s in G (let p^r be the order of P). We put $H := C \times P = CP \subset G$. We let $\psi_H \colon H \to \mathbb{Z}$ be the composition of $\psi_C \colon C \to \mathbb{Z}$ and the projection $C \times P \twoheadrightarrow C$.

Now we let $\psi_s := \mathrm{Ind}_H^G \psi_H$ and prove that ψ_s satisfies the conditions as desired. By the Frobenius character formula, for any $g \in G$, we have

$$\psi_s(g) = \mathrm{Ind}_H^G \psi_H(g) = \sum_{\substack{x \in H \backslash G \\ xgx^{-1} \in H}} \psi_H(xgx^{-1}).$$

Hence the condition (1) is clearly satisfied.

To check (2) and (3), let us take g to be a p'-element $s' \in G$. Then

$$\psi_s(s') = \sum_{\substack{x \in H\backslash G \\ xs'x^{-1} \in H}} \psi_H(xs'x^{-1}).$$

If $xs'x^{-1} \in H$, then we must have $xs'x^{-1} \in C$ since $xs'x^{-1}$ is a p'-element. Moreover, by the definitions of ψ_H and ψ_C, $\psi_H(xs'x^{-1})$ is not zero only when $xs'x^{-1} = s$. Hence, if s' is not conjugate to s, we must have $\psi_s(s') = 0$. If $s' = s$, we get

$$\sum_{\substack{x \in H\backslash G \\ xsx^{-1} \in H}} \psi_H(xsx^{-1}) = \frac{1}{|H|} \sum_{\substack{x \in G \\ xsx^{-1} = s}} m = \frac{1}{mp^r} \cdot |Z_G(s)| \cdot m = \frac{|Z_G(s)|}{p^r}.$$

This is an integer which is not 0 modulo p since p^r is the largest power of p dividing $|Z_G(s)|$ (it is the order of a p-Sylow subgroup). □

Corollary 6.13. *There exists an element $\psi \in V_p \otimes_{\mathbb{Z}} \mathbb{Z}[\mu_d]$ such that*

(1) *ψ takes values in $\mathbb{Z}$ (viewed as a class function $\psi\colon G \to \mathbb{C}$), and*
(2) *$\psi(g) \not\equiv 0 \pmod{p}$ for any $g \in G$.*

Proof. Let $s_1, \dots, s_n$ be a set of representatives of conjugacy classes of all p'-elements of G. For each s_i, we consider the function $\psi_{s_i}\colon G \to \mathbb{Z}$ as in Proposition 6.12. We put $\psi := \sum_{i=1}^n \psi_{s_i}\colon G \to \mathbb{Z}$; this is an element of $V_p \otimes_{\mathbb{Z}} \mathbb{Z}[\mu_d]$.

We check that this function satisfies the condition (2). If g is a p'-element, then (2) is clearly satisfied. Indeed, since there exists a unique s_j such that s_j is conjugate to g, we have

$$\psi(g) = \sum_{i=1}^n \psi_{s_i}(g) = \psi_{s_j}(g) \not\equiv 0 \pmod{p}$$

by the properties of ψ_{s_i}'s.

So let us consider the general case; let g be an element of G with p-Jordan decomposition $g = su$. In this case, it suffices to show that $\psi(g) \equiv \psi(s) \pmod{p}$. We put $C := \langle g \rangle$. As the restriction of ψ to C belongs to $\mathbb{Z}[\mu_d][\mathrm{Irr}(C)]$, we may write

$$\psi|_C = \sum_{k=1}^N a_k \chi_k,$$

where $a_k \in \mathbb{Z}[\mu_d]$ and $\chi_k \in \mathrm{Irr}(C)$. If we let p^r be the order of u, then $g^{p^r} = s^{p^r}$. Hence we get

$$\begin{aligned}
\psi(g)^{p^r} = \Big(\sum_{k=1}^N a_k \chi_k(g)\Big)^{p^r} &\equiv \sum_{k=1}^N a_k^{p^r} \chi_k(g)^{p^r} \\
&= \sum_{k=1}^N a_k^{p^r} \chi_k(s)^{p^r} \\
&\equiv \Big(\sum_{k=1}^N a_k \chi_k(s)\Big)^{p^r} = \psi(s)^{p^r} \pmod{p\mathbb{Z}[\mu_d]}.
\end{aligned}$$

As both $\psi(g)$ and $\psi(s)$ are integers, this implies that

$$\psi(g)^{p^r} \equiv \psi(s)^{p^r} \pmod{p}$$

(using that $p\mathbb{Z}[\mu_d] \cap \mathbb{Z} = p\mathbb{Z}$), which furthermore implies that $\psi(g) \equiv \psi(s) \pmod{p}$. □

To show the pre-Brauer theorem, we introduce a few more results.
For a cyclic group C, we define a function $\theta_C \colon C \to \mathbb{C}$ by

$$\theta_C(g) := \begin{cases} |C| & \text{if } \langle g \rangle = C, \\ 0 & \text{otherwise.} \end{cases}$$

Proposition 6.14. *Let G be a finite group. Then*

$$|G| \cdot \mathbb{1}_G = \sum_{C \subset G} \operatorname{Ind}_C^G \theta_C,$$

where the sum is over all cyclic subgroups $C \subset G$.

Proof. By the Frobenius character formula, for any $g \in G$, we have

$$\operatorname{Ind}_C^G \theta_C(g) = \sum_{\substack{x \in C \backslash G \\ xgx^{-1} \in C}} \theta_C(xgx^{-1}) = \sum_{\substack{x \in C \backslash G \\ xgx^{-1} \text{ generates } C}} |C| = \sum_{\substack{x \in G \\ xgx^{-1} \text{ generates } C}} 1.$$

Therefore, we have

$$\sum_{C \subset G} \operatorname{Ind}_C^G \theta_C(g) = \sum_{C \subset G} \sum_{\substack{x \in G \\ xgx^{-1} \text{ generates } C}} 1.$$

For any $g \in G$ and $x \in G$, there is exactly one cyclic subgroup $C \subset G$ such that xgx^{-1} generates C. Hence we get

$$\sum_{C \subset G} \sum_{\substack{x \in G \\ xgx^{-1} \text{ generates } C}} 1 = |G|.$$

This completes the proof. □

Lemma 6.15. *Let C be a cyclic group. Then $\theta_C \in \mathbb{Z}[\operatorname{Irr}(C)]$.*

Proof. We proceed with induction on the order of C. Since the statement is trivial for $|C| = 1$, we assume that $|C| > 1$. By Proposition 6.14, we have

$$|C| \cdot \mathbb{1}_C = \sum_{C' \subset C} \operatorname{Ind}_{C'}^C \theta_{C'} = \theta_C + \sum_{C' \subsetneq C} \operatorname{Ind}_{C'}^C \theta_{C'},$$

where the sum is over all subgroups of C. By the induction hypothesis, we have $\theta_{C'} \in \mathbb{Z}[\operatorname{Irr}(C')]$ for any $C' \subsetneq C$, hence $\operatorname{Ind}_{C'}^C \theta_{C'} \in \mathbb{Z}[\operatorname{Irr}(C)]$. As $|C| \cdot \mathbb{1}_C \in \mathbb{Z}[\operatorname{Irr}(C)]$, we get $\theta_C \in \mathbb{Z}[\operatorname{Irr}(C)]$. □

Corollary 6.16. *Let G be a finite group of order d. Then any class function $f \colon G \to d\mathbb{Z}$ (i.e., the values are integers divisible by d) can be written as*

$$f = \sum_{C \subset G} \sum_{\chi \in \operatorname{Irr}(C)} c_{C,\chi} \operatorname{Ind}_C^G \chi$$

where the sum is over all cyclic subgroups of G and $c_{C,\chi} \in \mathbb{Z}[\mu_d]$.

Proof. By assumption, there exists a class function $f' \colon G \to \mathbb{Z}$ such that $f = d \cdot f'$. By Proposition 6.14, we may write

$$d \cdot \mathbb{1}_G = \sum_{C \subset G} \operatorname{Ind}_C^G \theta_C.$$

Thus, by the projection formula, we have

$$f = d \cdot f' = \sum_{C \subset G} (\operatorname{Ind}_C^G \theta_C) \cdot f' = \sum_{C \subset G} \operatorname{Ind}_C^G (\theta_C \cdot f'|_C).$$

Here, $\theta_C \cdot f'|_C$ is written as a $\mathbb{Z}[\mu_d]$-linear combination of characters of C. Indeed, for any $\chi \in \operatorname{Irr}(C)$, we have

$$(\theta_C \cdot f'|_C, \chi)_C = \frac{1}{|C|} \sum_{c \in C} \theta_C(c) \cdot f'|_C(c) \cdot \overline{\chi(c)}.$$

Since $\theta_C(c)$ is divisible by $|C|$, $f'|_C(c)$ is an integer, and $\chi(c) \in \mu_d$, we must have that $(\theta_C \cdot f'|_C, \chi)_C \in \mathbb{Z}[\mu_d]$. This completes the proof. □

Now let us complete the proof of Theorem 6.9.

Proof of Theorem 6.9. Let $d := |G| = p^r \cdot m$. To show the assertion, it is enough to show that $m\mathbb{1}_G \in V_p$. Indeed, if we can show this, then the finite abelian group $\mathbb{Z}[\operatorname{Irr}(G)]/V_p$ is killed by m-multiplication. Hence its order must divide a power of m.

We consider the finite $\mathbb{Z}$-algebra $\mathbb{Z}[\mu_d] \subset \mathbb{C}$ generated by the d-th roots of unity μ_d over $\mathbb{Z}$. Since $V_p = (V_p \otimes_{\mathbb{Z}} \mathbb{Z}[\mu_d]) \cap \mathbb{Z}[\operatorname{Irr}(G)]$ (where the intersection and the equality are considered in $\mathbb{C}[\operatorname{Irr}(G)]$), in order to show that $m\mathbb{1}_G \in V_p$, it is enough to show that $m\mathbb{1}_G \in V_p \otimes_{\mathbb{Z}} \mathbb{Z}[\mu_d]$.

Let $\psi \in V_p \otimes_{\mathbb{Z}} \mathbb{Z}[\mu_d]$ be an element as in Corollary 6.13. If we let $N := |(\mathbb{Z}/p^r\mathbb{Z})^\times|$, then we have $\psi^N \equiv \mathbb{1}_G \pmod{p^r}$. Hence $m(\psi^N - \mathbb{1}_G)$ takes integer values divisible by $mp^r = d$. By Corollary 6.16, we can write

$$m(\psi^N - \mathbb{1}_G) = \sum_{C \subset G} c_C \operatorname{Ind}_C^G \pi$$

for some integers $c_C \in \mathbb{Z}[\mu_d]$ and $\pi \in \mathbb{Z}[\operatorname{Irr}(C)]$, where the sum is over all cyclic subgroups of G. As any cyclic group is p-elementary, we see that the right-hand side belongs to $V_p \otimes_{\mathbb{Z}} \mathbb{Z}[\mu_d]$. On the other hand, since $V_p \otimes_{\mathbb{Z}} \mathbb{Z}[\mu_d]$ is an ideal of the ring $\mathbb{Z}[\mu_d][\operatorname{Irr}(G)]$, we have $m\psi^N \in V_p \otimes_{\mathbb{Z}} \mathbb{Z}[\mu_d]$. Therefore, we also get

$$m\mathbb{1}_G = m\psi^N - m(\psi^N - \mathbb{1}_G) \in V_p \otimes_{\mathbb{Z}} \mathbb{Z}[\mu_d].$$

□

6.6. **Exercises.**

Exercise 6.1. Let G be a finite group. Let $f \in C(G)$ be a class function $G \to \mathbb{C}$. Prove that f is the character of a virtual representation of G (or equivalently, a $\mathbb{Z}$-linear combination of the characters of irreducible representations) if and only if $f|_H$ is the character of a virtual representation of H for any elementary subgroup $H \in \mathcal{E}$.

Exercise 6.2. Let G be a finite group. For $n \in \mathbb{Z}_{>0}$, we define a $\mathbb{C}$-linear map $\Psi_n \colon C(G) \to C(G)$ by

$$\Psi_n(f)(g) := f(g^n).$$

(This map is called the *Adams operator*.) Suppose that $(|G|, n) = 1$.

(1) For any subgroup $H \subset G$ and a 1-dimensional representation $\chi \in \mathrm{Irr}(H)$, prove that
$$\Psi_n(\Theta_{\mathrm{Ind}_H^G \chi}) = \Theta_{\mathrm{Ind}_H^G \chi^n}.$$
(2) Prove that Ψ_n maps a virtual representation to a virtual representation (i.e., if f is the character of a virtual representation, then so is $\Psi_n(f)$).
(3) Prove that Ψ_n maps an irreducible representation of G to an irreducible representation of G.

7. Lecture 7: Representations of topological groups

7.1. **Observation.** Now let us think about representations of infinite groups.

We start with the case where $G = \mathbb{R}$. Let us consider the following pathological example. We first regard $\mathbb{R}$ as a $\mathbb{Q}$-vector space and choose a basis containing 1 and $\sqrt{2}$. Let $f\colon \mathbb{R} \to \mathbb{R}$ be a $\mathbb{Q}$-linear homomorphism determined by

$$f(1) = 0, \quad f(\sqrt{2}) = \pi = 3.1415\ldots,$$

and $f(v) = 0$ for any other basis vector $v \in \mathbb{R}$. If we define $\chi_f\colon \mathbb{R} \to \mathbb{C}^\times$ by

$$\chi_f(r) := e^{if(r)},$$

then this is a homomorphism. In other words, $(\chi_f, \mathbb{C})$ is a 1-dimensional representation of $\mathbb{R}$.

Note that, here I just randomly chose "$\sqrt{2}$" and "π". You can construct infinitely many this kind of examples easily by replacing $\{1, \sqrt{2}\}$ (and also $\{0, \pi\}$) with any set of $\mathbb{Q}$-linearly independent numbers. Especially, we see that there are uncontrollably many representations even in the case of a really basic group like $\mathbb{R}$.

The problem here is that, of course, χ_f is not continuous. So, the lesson from this example is that, when studying a group equipped with a topology ("topological group"), it is reasonable to restrict our attention to representations that are compatible with its topology. However, then we have to think about what "compatible with its topology" means. More precisely, if it simply means the "continuity", does it mean the continuity of the map

$$G \times V \to V,$$

or

$$G \to \mathrm{Aut}_{\mathbb{C}}(V)$$

(or something else)? In any case, if V is an infinite-dimensional $\mathbb{C}$-vector space, it is not clear what kind of topology we should give to V, and also $\mathrm{Aut}_{\mathbb{C}}(V)$.

Therefore, what we first have to do is to introduce a reasonable class of representations which reflects the nature of a topology of a given group G correctly.

7.2. **Topological groups.**

Definition 7.1. A group G is called a topological group if it is equipped with a topology such that

- G is Hausdorff,
- $G \times G \to G\colon (g, h) \mapsto gh$ is continuous, and
- $G \to G\colon g \mapsto g^{-1}$ is continuous.

Let us list several basic properties of a topological group.

Proposition 7.2. *Let G be a topological group.*

(1) (a) *For any $g \in G$, the left-translation map and the right-translation map*

$$G \to G\colon x \mapsto gx, \quad G \to G\colon x \mapsto xg$$

are homeomorphisms.

(b) *The inverse map*

$$G \to G\colon x \mapsto x^{-1}$$

is a homeomorphism.

(c) *For any $g \in G$, the conjugation map*

$$G \to G \colon x \mapsto gxg^{-1}$$

is a homeomorphism.

(2) *For any subgroup H of G, its closure $\overline{H}$ is again a subgroup of G.*

(3) *Any open subgroup of G is a closed subgroup of G.*

Example 7.3. (1) Any finite group is a topological group with respect to the discrete topology.

(2) The set of real numbers $\mathbb{R}$ is a topological group with respect to its addition and the Euclidean topology.

(3) The group $\mathrm{GL}_n(\mathbb{C})$ of n-by-n invertible matrices is a topological group with respect to its matrix multiplication and the induced topology from $\mathrm{GL}_n(\mathbb{C}) \subset M_n(\mathbb{C}) \cong \mathbb{C}^{\oplus n^2}$. (This is an example of a Lie group.)

(4) For any field F and its Galois extension E (possibly infinite), its Galois group $\mathrm{Gal}(E/F)$ is a topological group with respect to the Krull topology (profinite topology).

Remark 7.4. There might be several reasons why we restrict ourselves only to Hausdorff topological groups. For example, one reason is the following. Let G be a topological group which may not necessarily be Hausdorff. We consider the closure of the trivial subgroup $N := \overline{\{1\}} \subset G$. Then, this is a closed subgroup by Proposition 7.2 (2). Furthermore, it is normal. Indeed, for any $g \in G$, the conjugation map $G \to G \colon x \mapsto gxg^{-1}$ is a homeomorphism. In particular, it maps N to the smallest closed subgroup of G which contains 1, that is, N itself. Therefore, it makes sense to consider the quotient group G/N, which is again a topological group with respect to the quotient topology. Furthermore, by Exercise 7.2, this quotient group is Hausdorff. If we want to study continuous representations of G, then the action of N must be necessarily trivial (e.g., consider a continuous homomorphism $G \to \mathrm{GL}_n(\mathbb{C})$). Hence there is no difference between representation theories of G and G/N.

7.3. **Topological vector spaces.**

Definition 7.5. A $\mathbb{C}$-vector space V (possible infinite-dimensional) is said to be a *topological $\mathbb{C}$-vector space* if it is Hausdorff and the maps

$$V \times V \to V \colon (v, w) \mapsto v + w, \quad \mathbb{C} \times V \to V \colon (a, v) \mapsto a \cdot v$$

are both continuous.

We remark that if V is finite-dimensional (say $\dim_{\mathbb{C}} V = n$), then V is in fact isomorphic to $\mathbb{C}^{\oplus n}$ as a topological $\mathbb{C}$-vector space. However, if V is inifinite-dimensional, there might be various different topologies on V so that V is a topological vector space.

Example 7.6. Let V be a $\mathbb{C}$-vector space consisting of sequences $a = (a_n)_{n \in \mathbb{N}}$ of complex numbers such that $a_n \neq 0$ only for finitely many natural numbers $n \in \mathbb{N}$. If we put e_n to be the sequence with $a_m = \delta_{m,n}$ (Kronecker's delta), then we simply have

$$V := \bigoplus_{n=0}^{\infty} \mathbb{C} e_n.$$

We define the following two kinds of norms on V:

$$\|a\|_1 := \sum_{n=0}^{\infty} |a_n|, \quad \|a\|_2 := \Big(\sum_{n=0}^{\infty} |a_n|^2\Big)^{\frac{1}{2}}.$$

Then these norms are not equivalent; more precisely, the norm topology with respect to $\| - \|_1$ is finer. Indeed, for any $a \in V$, we have

$$\|a\|_2^2 = \sum_{n=0}^{\infty} |a_n|^2 \leq \Big(\sum_{n=0}^{\infty} |a_n|\Big)^2 = \|a\|_1^2.$$

This means that two points $a, a' \in V$ are close to each other with respect to $\| - \|_1$, then they are also close with respect to $\| - \|_2$. However, for example, if we put

$$a^{(N)} := \frac{1}{N}(e_0 + \cdots + e_{N-1}) \in V,$$

then we have

$$\|a^{(N)}\|_1 = N \cdot \frac{1}{N} = 1, \quad \|a^{(N)}\|_2 = \sqrt{N \cdot \frac{1}{N^2}} = \frac{1}{\sqrt{N}}.$$

This means that the sequence $\{a^{(N)}\}_{N \in \mathbb{N}}$ converges to 0 with respect to the norm $\| - \|_2$ but not with respect to $\| - \|_1$.

Now we define the notion of a continuous representation.

Definition 7.7. Let G be a topological group and (π, V) a representation of G. We say that (π, V) is a *continuous representation* if V is a topological $\mathbb{C}$-vector space such that the action map

$$G \times V \to V \colon (g, v) \mapsto g \cdot v$$

is continuous.

7.4. **Hilbert space representations.** We next consider when we can develop a satisfactory theory on semisimple representations of a given group G. Recall that every finite-dimensional representation of every finite group is semisimple. However, when a group G is infinite, the semisimplicity is no longer true without conditions.

For example, let us consider the following (from Exercises in Lecture 1):

Example 7.8. Let $G := \mathbb{Z}$. We consider the 2-dimensional representation (π, V) of G defined by $V = \mathbb{C}^{\oplus 2}$ and

$$\pi \colon \mathbb{Z} \to \mathrm{GL}_2(\mathbb{C}) \colon n \mapsto \begin{pmatrix} 1 & n \\ 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix}.$$

Then (π, V) is not semisimple.

In this example, $\mathbb{Z}$ is thought of as a topological group with respect to the discrete topology. Also, V is finite-dimensional, we can put on V a canonical structure of a topological $\mathbb{C}$-vector space. The representation (π, V) is continuous with respect to these topologies. So, what we should learn from this example is that the semisimplicity fails even in such a basic situation.

Here, let us go back to the proof of the semisimplicity of finite-dimensional representations of a finite group. Recall that the key is the unitarity of a representation (π, V), i.e., existence of a G-invariant inner product on V. If a representation (π, V) has such a nice inner product, then we can find a G-invariant complement of any

G-subspace of V (Lemma 1.16). (So the point is that we can always find such an inner product in any representation in the case of finite groups; Proposition 1.18).

Keeping this in mind, we may understand that one of the natural classes of representations of a topological group G is continuous representations realized on a topological $\mathbb{C}$-vector space equipped with a G-invariant inner product.

However, here we also have the following observation:

Example 7.9. Let us again consider the $\mathbb{C}$-vector space V consisting of sequence $a = (a_n)_{n\in\mathbb{N}}$ with only finitely many nonzero entries. If we define an inner product on V by

$$((a_n)_n, (b_n)_n) := \sum_{n=0}^{\infty} a_n \cdot \overline{b_n},$$

then the norm $\| - \|_2$ is nothing but the norm determined by this inner product. Insider the space V, we consider the following subspace:

$$W := \left\{ a = (a_n)_n \in V \;\middle|\; \sum_{n=0}^{\infty} \frac{a_n}{2^n} = 0 \right\} \subset V.$$

Then we can check that W is a proper closed subspace of V. (Closedness can be checked by noting that W is the kernel of a homomorphism $V \to \mathbb{C}\colon a \mapsto \sum_{n=0}^{\infty} \frac{a_n}{2^n}$, which is continuous.) However, we also see that its orthogonal complement is zero

$$W^{\perp} := \{a \in V \mid (a, b) = 0 \text{ for any } b \in W\} = 0.$$

Indeed, for any $n > 0$, we have

$$e_0 - 2^n e_n \in W.$$

Hence, if $a = (a_n)_n \in W^{\perp}$, then we have

$$(a, e_0 - 2^n e_n) = a_0 - 2^n a_n = 0.$$

This means that, for any $n > 0$, $a_0 = 0$ if and only if $a_n = 0$. If $a_0 \neq 0$, then $a_n \neq 0$ for all $n > 0$, which contradicts to that $a \in V$. Hence $a = 0$.

As this example shows, in general (i.e., in the infinite-dimensional case), we cannot always take the orthogonal decomposition even if a norm is given. This observation naturally leads us to the notion of a Hilbert space:

Definition 7.10. Let V be a topological $\mathbb{C}$-vector space whose topology is given by the norm associated to an inner product $(-,-)$ on V. We call V a *Hilbert space* if V is complete.

Theorem 7.11 (Orthogonal decomposition of a Hilbert space)**.** *Let V be a Hilbert space. For any closed subspace W, its orthogonal complement $W^{\perp}$ satisfies $V = W \oplus W^{\perp}$.*

7.5. **Unitary representations.** Now, following the case of finite groups, let us introduce the notion of a unitary representation.

Definition 7.12. Let G be a topological group and V a Hilbert space. A *unitary representation* of G on V is a continuous representation (π, V) such that

$$(\pi(g)v, \pi(g)w) = (v, w)$$

for all $g \in G$ and $v, w \in V$.

Example 7.13. Note that the pathological example $\chi_f \colon \mathbb{R} \to \mathbb{C}$ takes values in $\mathbb{C}^1 := \{z \in \mathbb{C} \mid |z| = 1\}$. In other words, it satisfies unitarity condition with respect to the standard norm of $\mathbb{C}$. Thus we can see that the continuity condition is independent of the unitarity condition for a representation of a topological group.

With this definition, we can prove the following by the exactly same proof as in the finite group case (Lemma 1.16).

Lemma 7.14. *Let G be a topological group and (π, V) be a unitary representation of G. Then, for any closed subrepresentation $W \subset V$, there exists a subrepresentation $W' \subset V$ such that $V = W \oplus W'$.*

Consequently, we can also show the following:

Corollary 7.15. *Any finite-dimensional unitary representation of a topological group G is semisimple.*

However, we have to note that here we crucially need the finiteness of the dimension. If the dimeision of a unitary representation (π, V) is infinite, then the procedure of dividing V into smaller pieces might not stop at any stage. So at least we cannot prove the semisimplicity in general.

What we will learn from the next week will be the case of compact topological groups, where all these problems can be resolved.

7.6. **Exercises.**

Exercise 7.1. Prove Proposition 7.2.

Exercise 7.2. Let G be a topological group which may not necessarily be Hausdorff. Show that the following are equivalent:

(1) G is Hausdorff,
(2) the trivial subgroup $\{1\} \subset G$ is closed.

Appendix A. Regulations for exercise sessions and grading

This course has Exercise Sessions once every four lectures. Thus it will be like:

$$\text{2h lecture} \to \text{2h lecture} \to \text{2h lecture} \to \text{2h Exercise Session}$$
$$\to \text{2h lecture} \to \text{2h lecture} \to \text{2h lecture} \to \text{2h Exercise Session} \to \cdots$$

The grade for this course will be determined by

(1) written reports and
(2) oral presentations.

Lecture notes will be uploaded for each lecture, and exercise problems will be included in the notes. Solve these problems and submit your solutions. Basically, you can receive up to **4 points** for each problem. Your final score will be the total number of points you earn. Please collect as many points as you want!

However, I also would like to introduce the following special rules:

- You can receive up to **80 points** in total by submitting written reports.
- If you give an oral presentation of your solution to any problem at the blackboard during an Exercise Session, you can receive up to **20 points**.
- To pass the course, you must give an oral presentation **at least once**.

Example A.1. (1) [oral $\varnothing$] + [written 80 pts] $\rightsquigarrow$ [No credit].
(2) [oral 5 pts] + [written 80 pts] $\rightsquigarrow$ [85 pts].
(3) [oral 15 pts] + [oral 20 pts] + [written 70 pts] $\rightsquigarrow$ [100 pts].
(4) [oral 20 pts]$\times$5 +[written $\varnothing$] $\rightsquigarrow$ [100 pts].

The detailed regulations are explained below.

A.1. **Written reports.**

(1) Please submit your written solution through NTU COOL or by email to me.
(2) You may submit your reports at any time during the semester.
(3) After each Exercise Session, the reports submitted up to that point will be returned to you with your score and brief feedback.
(4) After getting a feedback, if your score is less than 4, you can modify your solution following the feedback and **re-submit up to once**. If your re-submitted solution is improved, you may get more points.

A.2. **Oral presentations.**

(1) During an Exercise Session, students will present solutions problems they chose at the blackboard.
(2) Each presentation must be given **within 15 minutes**, and then a 5 minutes question/comment time will be given. (So, at maximum, 6 students can give oral presentations in one Exercise Session.)
(3) Before each Exercise Session, students can express which problem they want to present (through the google spread sheet for this course).
    - The list of students and their preferred problems will be visible to everyone.
    - Each student can select more than one problems.
    - If two or more students wish to present the same problem, priority will be given to the student who has given fewer oral presentations. (If they

have given the same number of oral presentations, the presenter will be selected randomly.)
    - Within the day before an Exercise Session, the list of presenters will be announced.
    - I would like to do my best so that presentation opportunities will be allocated to every student equally.
(4) If you are selected as a presenter, please prepare a 15-minute presentation of your solution. You should try to explain your argument so that the other students, TA (Hao-An Wu), and I can follow it. Please regard this as an opportunity to develop your presentation skills.
(5) In addition to the oral presentation, **the presenter must submit a written solution** to the problem by the Exercise Session.
(6) You will receive feedback on your written solution and may revise and resubmit it afterward. An improved written solution may result in a higher score as well. However, the quality of your oral presentation has most weights. For example;
    - Suppose that you have prepared your presentation seriously, but during the presentation a mistake in your argument is discovered and the proof breaks down. This is not necessarily a serious problem. If you understand the issue through the subsequent discussion and successfully correct it in your revised written solution, you may still receive a high score.
    - On the other hand, suppose that your written solution is perfect, but it is clear that you have not prepared for the presentation. Similarly, if you are unable to explain your own argument or answer basic questions about your solution, this may result in a low score even if the written solution itself is excellent.

A.3. **Q & A.**

Question 1. Can I give an oral presentation of a problem which were already presented by someone at the blackboard?

Answer 1. No. Each problem can be presented at the brackboard at most once.

Question 2. Can I submit a written solution to a problem which were already presented by someone at the blackboard?

Answer 2. Yes. In this case, probably you already got to know how to solve the problem. However, what is important in writing a report is not only its correctness, but also how it is organized/explained. Please try to write a report in your words with your understanding even if you already have listened to other student's oral presentation on the problem.

Question 3. Can I submit all written solutions together at the end of the course?

Answer 3. Yes, in principle. However, please keep in mind that it will be more difficult for you to know how many points you can get precisely in advance.

Question 4. Is there any other necessary condition to get the course credit (e.g., attendance)?

Answer 4. No, but please do not forget to give an oral presentation at least once.

References

[Ser77] J.-P. Serre, *Linear representations of finite groups*, Springer-Verlag, New York-Heidelberg, 1977, Translated from the second French edition by Leonard L. Scott, Graduate Texts in Mathematics, Vol. 42.

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